

Boundarism

——A Guide for the AI Era

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Foreword

Why Humanity Must Re-Answer the Question: What Does It Mean to Be Human?

When AI starts to speak, think and make decisions like a human being, humanity will be forced to confront a question we've never truly had to face before: what does it mean to be human? To ask that question is to lead straight to equality – equality only exists between humans. A believer and a heretic will never be equal, because to the believer, the heretic isn't human at all. That's why the root of all social strife and global conflict today is this: the explosive growth of productivity since the Industrial Revolution has draped pre-medieval ideas in a cloak of modernity. But for all that, these are still problems *between humans*. With the birth of AI, if we cannot make sense of our past, humanity faces an unimaginably dangerous future.

I don't pretend to have the ultimate definition of a human being here. Instead, I want to start from a colder truth: human finitude. Finitude is what gives us our innate boundaries. So not everything with boundaries is human, but nothing *without* boundaries can ever be human. A boundary is a verifiable structure: it means acknowledging the inviolability of others' boundaries outwardly, and being willing to take responsibility for your own actions inwardly – the freedom to walk away, and the freedom to let others walk away too. The establishment of boundaries was the dawn of modern civilisation; it

made cooperation between humans possible, rather than subjugation and servitude.

Many people think equality should exist like air, as if it's been with us since the dawn of humanity. The truth could not be more different. Equality is not a natural fact, but a product of civilisation. No animal debates equality: a Tyrannosaurus rex would never talk equality with a Triceratops, nor would Viking raiders with the Xiongnu hordes. When violence is the primary mechanism of coordination, the world only knows strength and weakness, not mutual recognition. The emergence of so-called "equality" meant humanity invented something counter to our instincts: the ability to recognise that another person is first and foremost a human being – and thus has boundaries that cannot be crossed at will – even when there's no benefit in it, even when there's conflict. The idea that a defeated enemy deserves a military trial is less than 100 years old.

That's why, before we can define what a human is, we must ask: where does equality come from? It's an uncomfortable question, because it forces us to admit a reality: equality needs an anchor. Without that anchor, the power to interpret equality falls to humanity itself – and if that's the case, equality becomes nothing more than a tool, a subjective gift rather than an objective truth. Throughout history, humanity has offered many anchors for the idea that "the other is human": some appeal to a transcendent power – God, the Dao, nature – a power that even earthly authority must bow to; some to

natural law and reason, arguing that humans recognise each other because we share rationality; some to human dignity, holding that humans are an end in themselves, never a means to an end. These expressions use different words and start from different places, but their function is uncannily the same: they all seek to draw an unbreakable line between power and the individual.

Because if that line disappears, equality devolves into a slogan, and humans risk becoming nothing more than a KPI for those in power. And when equality is just a slogan, whoever controls the interpretation can turn it into a commodity of emotion – and then turn that emotional commodity into a tool of domination.

When a person or an organisation cannot answer where equality comes from, their order can only be sustained by two things: morality, or violence – or both. Morality here is rarely inner virtue; it's a high ground of abstraction, using vague words like justice, security, health and civilisation to claim infinite interpretive power. Violence is more direct: it sustains obedience through fear. Both lead to the same end: respect is given selectively, and withdrawn selectively. Once respect can be withdrawn, the other can be demoted at any time – and demotion paves the way for dehumanisation. Then communication and trade cease to be based on contracts, and devolve into three outcomes: plunder, compromise, and charity. So-called "cooperation" is just a different packaging for power imbalances; so-called "dialogue" is just an exchange of positions and fear.

This is the real danger of the AI era. When a non-human being possesses unprecedented power, the world will instinctively treat it either as a tool – and tools are meant to be abused – or as some kind of transcendent being, making humans its tools. We are left with a sharper paradox: how to ensure a supremely powerful AI becomes neither an abused tool nor humanity's new master. The answer won't come from prettier slogans or abstract words, but from tighter boundaries: boundaries with clear definitions, the freedom to opt out, and a clear chain of responsibility. Because in the face of AI, what really needs to be aligned is never the AI itself – it's humanity's own willingness to recognise boundaries.

Boundarism is born in this moment. It is not an emotion, nor a position, but a re-marking of civilisation after examining thousands of years of human history from a neutral perspective: many things we take for granted are not companions of civilisation, but mere accidents of history. Freedom and equality are not innate properties of human civilisation, and scientific formulas are not debts the universe owes us. The speed of light is not constant for humanity's sake, and gravity does not exist for humanity's sake. We just happen to live in a stable, observable universe – and we've mistaken that lucky constancy for an entitlement, that all the blessings of civilisation are our default birthright.

Consider a ridiculous but incisive question: what would happen to humanity if the law of gravity changed today? The first thing to collapse would not be

philosophy or theology, but engineering: satellite orbits would fail, GPS would break down, aviation, navigation and space travel would lose their computational foundations, and the safety of every building on Earth would be null and void. Next would be the economy: logistics and navigation would grind to a halt, nothing could be priced, insurance could not calculate risk, the credit system would freeze, and the global economic system would stop dead in its tracks. Then people would instinctively revert to a theological mode: seeking someone to blame, creating enemies, and clinging to rituals for a false sense of security. You see, so-called "order" is just a product of a predictable physical world; so-called "civilisation" is just a fragile structure built on a few stable boundaries.

Boundarism seeks to correct this long-standing misperception: mistaking chance for necessity, side effects for rights, and stability for a cosmic duty to humanity. It will constantly remind us: civilisation is not a list of rights, but a chain of responsibility; not a set of moral slogans, but a structure of boundaries. When we pursue equality, we must first answer where it comes from; when we pursue scientific progress, we must remember that progress is never something the universe owes us, but something humanity earns through boundaries, discipline and sacrifice.

From here on, this book will no longer ask "what we hope the world will be like". Instead, it will ask a far more serious question: when the world does not act as we hope, how do we *be* human?

Prologue: The Three Fundamental Principles of Boundaries

If Boundarism were to have a single, enforceable, auditable "constitutional clause", it would be this: **boundaries precede existence** – a point we will explore in depth later. The boundaries of existence are not emotions or positions, but structure. By structure, I mean something whose existence can be judged from an external observer's perspective, without relying on the self-proclamations of any person or organisation. A person can claim to be kind, an organisation can claim to be just – these claims prove nothing on their own. Boundarism refuses to leave civilisation in the hands of proclamations; boundaries must be verifiable.

Boundarism breaks down boundaries into three essential elements: **clear definition, the freedom to opt out**, and **a chain of responsibility**. None can be missing: definition prevents language from being hijacked by power; the freedom to opt out prevents relational coercion; a chain of responsibility prevents the obfuscation of power. Together, they form the most basic immune system for civilisation in the AI era.

1. Clear Definition – Everything Except Life and Emotion Must Be Clearly Named

The first pillar of Boundarism is definition.

The definition I speak of here is not an academic word game, but an objective law based on reality: as long as a concept lacks a clear definition, power will

inevitably seize its interpretation. And once power controls the interpretation, discussion ends – all that remains is posturing and obedience.

Boundarism therefore demands: **everything except life and emotion must be clearly defined.**

Life and emotion are allowed to be vague, for they are personal experiences.

But when it comes to public affairs, rules, distribution, rewards and punishments, public health, and AI governance – clarity is non-negotiable.

Without it, the inevitable result is theologisation.

We now live in a world where the most common form of plunder is not guns and cannons, but abstract words: justice, security, health, civilisation, stability, the greater good, for the next generation. These words sound undeniably right, yet they all point to unverifiable facts, unenforceable actions, and unclear responsible parties. When definition is absent, abstract words become the masters of human life, and even asking questions is branded as heresy.

Boundarism's verdict here is clear: **no definition, no boundaries. No boundaries, only the freedom to be exploited.**

2. The Freedom to Opt Out – A Boundary Is First and Foremost a Door

The second element is the freedom to opt out. Because a contract without the right to exit is a chain: you can sign it, but you can't leave; you can agree, but you can't withdraw. Imagine a marriage that cannot be dissolved – not even separation or living apart is allowed, a marriage where you must share a room

no matter how toxic the relationship becomes. I think we all know what that looks like.

The freedom to opt out is not "running away at any time". Its meaning is more precise: **all relationships must allow parties to end them at a bearable cost.**

It implies two bottom lines:

- The right to exit: I can leave without being destroyed.
- The right to be exited from: you can leave without me destroying you. To deny this is to hold someone in a relationship by coercion.

True boundaries are symmetrical. Once symmetry is lost, the relationship corrupts – it becomes either one-sided privilege or one-sided punishment.

Boundarism's verdict here: **any relationship that denies the right to exit is not worthy of being called a contract.**

3. A Chain of Responsibility – Outcome, Traceability, Audit

Outcome

There's an old Chinese saying: every injustice has its perpetrator, every debt its debtor. In the language of Boundarism: **outcomes cannot be outsourced; decisions must bear consequences.** A mature civilisation does not reward those who pass the buck. A person may consult experts, use tools, reference models, and seek advice – but the final decision, the words "I choose to do this", can never disappear. It cannot be diluted by phrases like "it was the organisation's decision", "the system required it", "AI recommended it", or "for

the greater good". The greatest danger of the AI era is the temptation for humans to evade responsibility more easily: once we allow AI recommendations to become an excuse for exemption, AI will be deified, and its instructions will become the new divine edicts.

Traceability

Traceability is not a witch hunt; it is a civilisational engineering capability:

every action must be traceable back to its source. Who authorised it? Who designed it? Who executed it? Who profited from it? Who signed off on it? Who bears the consequences? These questions must have answers. Without them, there is no governance – only interpretation. The greater the interpretive power, the more sacred those who hold it become. And once a "sacred human being" exists, they can brand others as heretics.

Audit

The meaning of auditability goes far beyond checking accounts; it is a counter to interpretive power: **what happened? What was the basis? What data standards were used? Third parties must have the right to ask.** To ask, to receive an answer, to not be punished for asking, and to receive a verifiable answer. Any power that cannot be audited will eventually deify itself through abstract words.

Boundarism's verdict here: **once the chain of responsibility breaks, power obscures all boundaries. Once boundaries are obscured, modern civilisation reverts to a structure of theology and violence.**

Chapter 1: The Foundation – Why Civilisation Exists

1.1 Civilisation and the War for the Future

Civilisation is both inevitable and accidental. Sounds like a meaningless cliché, but it perfectly explains why history has patterns yet is always unforeseeable.

Its inevitability lies in this: when a society frees human nature, recognises human equality, and institutionalises contracts and chains of responsibility, it will unleash productivity as a matter of course. Equality breeds mutual recognition; mutual recognition breeds trade; trade breeds division of labour; division of labour breeds technological accumulation; and technological accumulation brings greater density of energy and information. In short, **as long as basic boundaries hold, the development of productivity has a strong direction** – that's the inevitability.

Its accidentality lies in this: productivity never advances to a textbook script. It doesn't progress at the same speed or along the same path in every society. Accidentality determines which breakthrough, which group of people, which sum of money, which war, which institutional flaw becomes the tipping point. These are like sparks landing on different patches of grass: some fizzle out fast, others set the plain ablaze. So history moves in similar directions, but its landscape is always entirely different.

This also explains why small local events can rewrite the world. Locked up in a federal prison, Maduro could never have imagined that his fate was not changed by a coup or a diplomatic rift, but by a tech acquisition 24 years earlier. In 2002, eBay bought PayPal – a seemingly ordinary business consolidation – but it unlocked a compounding network of talent and capital, which in turn shaped new national capabilities over a longer chain: data fusion, intelligence algorithms, cross-domain coordination, compressed action linkages, and improved enforceability. History does not unfold in linear cause and effect; it unfolds in the **compounding of capability networks** – a local business restructure decades ago can change the boundaries of what a nation is capable of decades later.

And so, twenty-four years on, rulers like Maduro find that so-called "international law", "national borders", and "security" offer no defence against this new structure of capability. Being taken from your bedroom, flying to the US visa-free, sitting down to talk with a federal judge – scenes that once only existed in novels are now reality. This is not a moral victory, nor a political one; it is a **victory of capability**. When capability changes, new rules are born.

With these new rules, war is redefined too. For over a century, the main axis of human political narrative has revolved around two words: collectivism and individualism. The former promises order, demands mobilisation and grand goals; the latter emphasises boundaries, rights and individual subjectivity.

Their clash endures to this day, and many still use early 20th-century

vocabulary to make sense of 21st-century reality: translating all conflict into ideological struggle, all victory and defeat into a moral judgment of institutional merit.

But I believe this century-old narrative axis has reached its end. Not because humanity has suddenly reached a consensus, but because reality has delivered a colder, unanswerable verdict: **modern competition is less won by moral narrative, and more by rewriting boundaries through systems.** The form of war has shifted from "occupation and rule" to "intelligence, coordination, speed, supply chains". The purpose of war has become this: since we will ultimately have to reach a contract, we will keep replacing leaders until we find someone who understands equality and abides by contracts – and if you refuse to replace them, we will do it for you.

This new logic has produced an absurd yet brutally effective proof – decapitation.

According to collectivism's own narrative, whether it's socialism, nationalism, or Shia political structures, the core tenet is this: the individual should merge into the collective, the leader is merely the bearer of collective will, the organisation is above the individual, and the system can grow organically. In other words, such systems claim to be de-personalised – they run not on individuals, but on an unshakable organisational structure and ideology.

When the light of decapitation shines on reality, all absurdity is laid bare in this lie detector test: decapitate such a system, and it will often suffer factual

failure, incapacity, even structural collapse. That's the absurdity: it preaches de-personalisation, but in practice it is highly personal; it claims the system is supreme, but in reality it compresses the system into a handful of nodes; it proclaims collective will, but in the end it only expresses the leader's will.

Decapitation is a mirror not because it is clever in itself, but because it reveals a truth humanity has spent decades learning: these regimes are not really republican contract systems at all, but **pre-modern node-based rule**.

To put it bluntly:

If capturing or eliminating a few people can significantly disable a nation's system, then that polity is essentially still pre-modern. It has no claim to modernity, let alone to being a republic.

The minimum prerequisite for a republic is the contract: power derives from authorisation, authorisation can be withdrawn, and the chain of responsibility stands up to audit. As long as these structures exist, those in power are merely interfaces – replace an interface, and the system can generate a new one, often a tougher one. Conversely, if a system's functionality is highly dependent on a small number of human nodes, it is not a contract community, but a tribal structure. Its order comes from fear and loyalty, not rational choice with the option to opt out.

The result is a curious one: decapitation, a primitive tribal act, has become a **litmus test for the modernity of political regimes**. A polity that fails this robustness test can never be a republic in the modern sense. War thus needs

to be redefined: it is no longer the climax of moral narrative, but a competition of capability structures. The methods and means of war depend on the target, not the steel juggernauts we traditionally associate with it. Here is Boundarism's verdict on the wars of the future: **if the end of war still relies on a contract, then the process of war is just two sides keep replacing leaders until they find someone they can trade with as equals.**

1.2 Capitalism and Boundaries

For over a century, humanity has endured countless social upheavals and large-scale disasters, many of which stem from an extremely stubborn misunderstanding: demonising capital, framing capitalism as an ideology, and then packaging war, revolution and slaughter as a just war against capital. This narrative shaped the linguistic structure of the Cold War, painting capitalism as a byword for greed, exploitation and corruption – so much so that any ideology opposed to it could claim to be the embodiment of justice, equality and the people. The absurdity of history is that even today, many still use this moralised narrative to explain the world, ignoring a basic categorical truth: **capitalism is not a moral claim; it is first and foremost a quantitative tool.**

Capitalism is not mysterious. It has only one core capability: **to price everything.** It quantifies time as interest rates and discount rates, uncertainty as risk (and calculates insurance for it), the future as credit, cooperation as contracts, and resource allocation as prices. Once things are quantified, the

world can be compared, calculated and settled. After settlement, the radius of trade expands, the division of labour deepens, and stable cooperation between strangers becomes possible. The essence of capitalism is not that money rules everything, but that it provides a **settlement tool that transcends differences in language, culture and race** – it is the infrastructure of civilisation.

Capitalism ushered in the Age of Discovery, the first time in human history that **a stranger's money was still money**. For most of human history, value only existed within networks of acquaintances: blood ties, tribes, guilds, clans. Strangers were not seen as equal subjects; their property needed no respect, their promises no fulfilment, their losses no accounting. For a long time, a stranger's money was not money – just plunder for the taking or scraps to be given away. Unsurprisingly, the radius of cooperation was extremely limited. Great adventures could only rely on royal favour or predatory conquest, never becoming a replicable social capability.

Capitalism's breakthrough was that it **put equality and contracts at its core, bringing strangers into a credible settlement system**. Strangers were no longer just a source of risk, but potential partners; their property was recognised as a right for the first time, their promises as a debt, their future as credit. And so something unprecedented happened: a person who wanted to sail the high seas no longer had to be a king's confidant or start by plundering. They could raise capital – borrow resources from a group of

complete strangers, and have them share the risks and rewards through a contract. The key here is not "investment", but that **risk could be priced, dispersed and settled between strangers for the first time.**

This had almost never happened in human history. It meant civilisation had broken free from the tribe for the first time in scale; cooperation no longer relied on the morality of acquaintances, but on **enforceable contractual boundaries.**

Looking at today's world, capitalism coexists with Finland and Sweden, with Thailand and the Philippines, with the United States. So capitalism is never an ideology – it is a tool. **The results capitalism produces depend on the people who use the tool.**

The quantitative tool itself is never the source of exploitation. On the contrary, capitalism's quantification, which makes invisible labour visible, is the first tool in human history that can systematically counter exploitation and achieve relative equality. **What truly nurtures exploitation is always the invisibility and opaqueness of labour.** A serf's labour was split into unpaid corvée for the lord and labour for their own survival, with no clear boundary between the two. The lord could arbitrarily increase corvée hours and the share of produce they demanded. Women's domestic and reproductive labour has run through human history, yet it has never been quantified, always dismissed as a natural duty.

The quantification of labour at the birth of capitalism was, in essence, a **revolutionary step towards equal rights**. It pulled labour out of personal dependence and patriarchal shackles for the first time, turning it into a visible benchmark that could be accounted for, compared and bargained over. It gave workers the most basic right for the first time – **the right to know**: you could clearly calculate how much labour you put in, how much value you created, and how much you were paid. I fully understand the anger humans felt when they gained this right for the first time. All the hatred of capitalism since the Enlightenment stems from workers realising they felt shortchanged after doing the maths. But ask yourself: did humans not work before capitalism? Was there any accounting for that labour? It's like a company that never kept financial statements doing them for the first time – the boss's first reaction is not to reflect on the past, but to yell at the accountant who made the statements.

As time passes, humanity should calm down and see capitalism for what it is: a **civilisational expander**. It expands the radius of trade, the depth of the division of labour, the efficiency of resource allocation. But an expander is not a steering wheel – it doesn't tell you where to drive, or which roads to avoid. It only amplifies your ability to drive, and that's why boundaries become critical. Capitalism does not automatically bring civilisation. When it quantifies everything, it will quantify conscience, morality and human organs – but **being**

quantifiable does not mean being tradable. Laws and social rules are the boundaries of quantification.

Equality, boundaries, contracts and capitalism are thus symbiotic. **Once boundaries are breached, capitalism immediately degenerates:** prices become plunder, contracts become coercion, credit becomes fraud. We then see a historical cycle: when a society denies the source of equality and refuses to recognise the boundaries of others, trade shrinks back to acquaintance networks, strangers become enemies again, and violence becomes the settlement method once more. People will then say capitalism has failed – but what has really failed is not the tool, but the humans who failed to hold the boundaries.

Boundarism's verdict on capitalism: **Capitalism makes the world settleable; laws and rules decide what should not be traded.**

1.3 Equality and Its Origins – The Ultimate Unification of Science and Theology

Equality is not air; it is fragile, because it will always be met with the question: **why?** Why should the boundaries of the weak be recognised? Why should the strong abide by contracts? Why should strangers see each other as kindred? Once the source of equality is not a consensus, it can only be sustained by morality and violence. Here we must emphasise a fundamental principle: **whatever the source of equality, it must never come from power.** Equality

that comes from human power can be given to you today, and taken away tomorrow. This is a bottom line, non-negotiable. **The source of equality must be a universal consensus that power cannot touch or revoke.** Only such equality has true stability and inviolability.

Throughout history, there have been several main sources of equality put forward:

There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free, there is neither male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus.

— Galatians 3:28

All men are created equal.

— The United States Declaration of Independence, 1776

Men being, by nature, all free, equal and independent.

— John Locke, *Second Treatise of Government*

Man is born free, and everywhere he is in chains.

— Jean-Jacques Rousseau, *The Social Contract* (1.1)

By nature all men are equal.

— Ulpian

All human beings are born free and equal in dignity and rights.

— Universal Declaration of Human Rights, Article 1, 1948

From these, we can roughly distil three main sources of equality:

transcendence, natural law, and innate dignity. Let us first address equality as granted by law – this is logically unsound. The essence of law is a contract, and the premise of a contract is mutual recognition; the premise of mutual recognition is equality, respect for each other's boundaries. **Law is thus a product of equality, not its cause.** Law can allocate rights, but it cannot create what makes a human a human. If a system can demote humans to non-humans, the same legal text can immediately become invalid for them. So law is at most a **carrier and mechanism for equality, not its source.**

Law can enforce equality, but it cannot generate it.

To attribute equality to law is to reverse cause and effect.

Next, innate dignity. The idea that all humans are born equal sounds natural enough – but then we face a question: were humans in tribal times truly human? Were humans between tribes equal? Did they respect each other? Did taking an enemy's head and hanging it on your belt carry any moral weight? For a long time, **us/them was the only boundary.** Adversarial tribes were often seen as prey, pollution, livestock – rarely as kindred. So equality has never been a natural concept; **it is a creation of civilisation.**

At this point, we are forced to admit a cold truth: law is not the source, equality is not innate, and natural law cannot resist power. The question of

where equality comes from is thus pushed to its core: **is there a source that still holds in the face of power? A source that makes the strong recognise the weak as human, the majority recognise minorities as human, the victors recognise the vanquished as human?**

The answer points in only one direction: **the source of equality must be higher than human will.** It can be called God, the will of the universe, the Dao, inviolability – the name is debatable, but the conclusion is non-negotiable. Because once the source of equality is reduced to something humans control, equality immediately devolves into a matter of interpretive power. Then some people will be defined as heretics, and heretics will be burned at the stake for all to see. In the last hundred years, we have seen this in Rwanda, the Katyn Massacre, the Khmer Rouge. If we fail to realise this, the slaughter of heretics will continue endlessly.

This is the meaning of transcendence: it is not an emotional comfort, but a **ceiling on power.** It tells those in power, tells humanity, that none of us are the measure of all things; everything operates within a certain limit. Only then is equality not a gift from the majority, not a pocket of power, but an **irrevocable bottom line.**

At this point, **science and theology achieve their ultimate unification in structure.** Many people think science and theology are inherently opposed, but when it comes to the boundary question of the source of equality, they perform almost identical tasks:

- **Theology:** All men are equal under God (Martin Luther). Its core is not religious interpretation, but a **boundary of power** – there is something higher than earthly power.
- **Science:** The laws of nature do not change according to human will. Its core is not technological worship, but a **boundary of reality** – the universe is not responsible to humanity.

Both express one core truth: **humans are not the measure of all things.**

The unmeasurable nature of the universe is isomorphic with transcendence.

Both science and theology tell humanity one thing: **humans have boundaries.** There are things humans cannot touch, things that are extremely dangerous even to attempt. Once you accept this conclusion, much of the absurdity of modern society becomes instantly clear: when humanity no longer recognises any transcendent boundaries, it will seek alternative anchors in abstract concepts like morality, justice, security, health, environmental protection. Once these anchors are created, they become sources of power and start manufacturing heretics, revoking boundaries, demoting others to non-humans – and civilisation thus degenerates.

The universe does not owe humanity a stable explanation. We have to face the fact that **all human achievements today are products of a certain stable, observable period of the universe.** No one knows if the speed of light will ever change, if the law of gravity has existed since the birth of the universe, or if it is just a transitional product.

From *Voluntarism* to *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, Nietzsche told us over a century ago that God is dead. Boundarism says: **now God is alive again**. Nietzsche declared the old transcendent explanations invalid; Boundarism points to the inevitable return of boundaries as a constraint mechanism. Since the Continental Enlightenment and the subsequent explosion of human productivity, humanity has seemingly made breaking boundaries an end in itself. **There are some boundaries humans cannot, and should not, cross – not even attempt to cross.**

Looking at this question from a biological perspective makes it even more intuitive. For life to be born – the first cell on Earth – the first thing created was a **boundary**. It was the double phospholipid membrane that gave birth to life; without it, Earth would still be just a pile of amino acids. The cell membrane does not just provide physical separation; it maintains the stable order within the cell. It selectively allows substances in and out, protecting the fragile internal life system while enabling necessary material and energy exchange with the outside world. This shows: **no boundaries, no order; no order, no life.**

Boundarism's verdict: **Science and theology unify in this – everything beyond human boundaries belongs to the transcendent.**

1.4 What Does It Mean to Be Human?

Based on our analysis of the basic concepts of capitalism, equality and the relationships between them, we have identified the fundamental reason for the detours human civilisation has taken over the last hundred years. Any plan for the future must be built on a summary of the past – because humanity is now facing a silicon-based life form far more powerful than ourselves, and if we cannot understand ourselves, we will never understand silicon-based life either.

So what *is* a human being? This is a question I only began to understand after becoming a father. When I raise a child, what exactly am I nurturing? I am not nurturing a target, an identity, or a set of correct answers. I am nurturing **a set of possibilities within the limits of my ability**. The limits are my capacity; the possibilities are their future. This realisation redefines a human being as: **a set of choices within boundaries**.

From the perspective of Boundarism, therefore, the **first nature of humanity is finitude**: finite life, finite cognition, finite rights and obligations. Finitude is so important because to recognise it is to generate boundaries – whether actively or passively. **Active finitude** means recognising boundaries, taking responsibility for consequences, allowing opt-outs, accepting audits. **Passive finitude** means humans must die, organisations must go bankrupt, wars must be lost. We have to face the fact that **recognising finitude is not a common sense for humanity as a whole**.

Then comes the **second nature: the principle of equality**. As we have discussed, equality is a product born of boundaries. Boundarism only cares about whether boundaries exist – the specific content of those boundaries is the business of each subject. Our repeated emphasis on equality is a necessary one, because trade, communication and contracts are all built on equality. A human cannot make a contract with a sheep to shear its wool, nor with a typhoon for a non-aggression pact.

From these two natures emerges humanity's most important right: **the right to choose**. Boundaries are the framework; equality is the coordinate system. Finitude forces choice to exist – finite time, finite resources, finite life, so every decision means giving something up. Equality gives choice a bottom line: I recognise you as human, so my choices will respect your rights. What this means is that **the other's suffering becomes a constraint on choice**. All human emphasis on moral and conscientious constraints stems from this. That is why dehumanisation and hereticisation are so terrifying: it is understandable that humans consider the suffering of other humans, but how many consider the suffering of chickens in a farm, or monkeys in a lab?

For civilisation to reach this point, it would be an act of profound stupidity for atrocities to still occur due to dehumanisation and hereticisation. Today's productivity has advanced to the point where civilisation only faces problems of **coordination and distribution of benefits** – no longer problems of resource allocation for survival. There is no longer a situation where if you take

one more bite, I will starve. So dehumanisation and hereticisation have no place to exist.

This brings us to why recognising the existence of the transcendent is in line with human nature. A chimpanzee that takes another chimpanzee's head and kicks it like a ball needs no moral explanation or hereticisation – but humans do. What does that mean? **Deep down, humans still feel a weight about doing this to their kind**, and need an outlet for that weight. When something needs an explanation, it is almost certainly wrong. So there is no shame in recognising something that transcends humanity. When famines occurred in human history, Chinese historical records write of "exchanging children to eat". Why exchange children? Red crabs in Australia never stop to wonder if the small crabs they eat are their offspring.

When we face the definition of a human being as "a set of possibilities within a finite framework", we will then have to face the **total rewriting of everything from education and public health policy to the world order**.

From the perspective of Boundarism, the world order established since World War II – and today's public health policies – are all wrong. Fortunately, things have been moving back in the right direction in the last few years. But it is also absurd that **common sense has become a scarce commodity today**.

Boundarism's definition of what it means to be human: **a set of possibilities within a finite framework – finitude, equality, and contracts that accept a chain of responsibility**.

1.5 Restructuring the World Order

The United Nations was founded on 24 October 1945. Its establishment rested on a clear premise: it assumed all signatory sovereign states were **subjects capable of entering into contracts**. Today, it is clear that the UN made a fundamental classification error at birth: it included a host of subjects that are **incapable of contracting**.

We have already discussed that contracts have prerequisites: they only exist between **two equal subjects**. Otherwise, a contract is merely a tool to buy time or a price to pay for compromise. Between unequal subjects, only three things exist: plunder, fraud, compromise and charity. Coercive trade by the strong against the weak is essentially plunder; compromise by the weak against the strong is essentially fraud; giving by the strong is charity and grace.

For decades, the concept of a republic has been a **subjective claim, not an objective condition**. In the eyes of Boundarism, the concept of a republic has a firm boundary: **clear definition, the right to opt out, a chain of responsibility**. The most important observable indicator here is **whether authorisation can be withdrawn**. Let us take Iran as a concrete example. The Islamic Revolution was an objectively chosen event – but in the subsequent developments, **can that choice be withdrawn? What is the way to express withdrawal? Can the results of withdrawal be counted and recognised? Does withdrawal carry an unbearable cost?**

As civilisation advances, we often encounter something remarkable: many human creations have become **untouchable, unquestionable objects**.

Whether it is religion, government, or ideology – these are all human creations. Yet questioning human creations can lead to being silenced, imprisoned, even killed. This is nothing short of absurd.

The world order thus **must be restructured**. Dalio is only half right about the world order: the original collective rules were wrong to begin with.

Communication, trade and contracts should only ever occur between **equal subjects**. The so-called rules of great powers are not the law of the jungle; they are the law of the jungle born from being trapped by the self-created cage of rules.

Boundarism is essentially **anti-infantilism** – but eighty years of civilisational progress since World War II have not made humans more mature; instead, they have mass-produced infantilism. We will discuss education later, but for the current changes in the world, it can be put simply: **we are returning to common sense**.

A normal world should classify nation-states into three types of subjects:

1. **Contractible subjects**: They can define boundaries, allow opt-outs, and have a complete chain of responsibility where authorisation can be withdrawn. For them, contracts are valid, trade is valid, mutual recognition is valid.

2. **Semi-contractible subjects:** They can cooperate in certain areas, but require strict scrutiny and clear opt-out thresholds. For them, contracts are not a threshold, but **risk pricing**.
3. **Non-contractible subjects:** When an organisation revokes mutual recognition in the name of an unquestionable sacredness, blocks opt-outs through fear, and evades responsibility through obfuscation – for them, contracts no longer have any binding force, only tactical value. The only way to deal with them is: **reduce dependence, restrict communication, cut off channels, and deter with force**.

It is a mystery to me why sovereignty is elevated to a sacred, inviolable level.

Did humanity not exist for thousands of years before the Westphalian system?

It is understandable that the UN sought to expand the radius of cooperation, constrain behaviour through contracts, and achieve peace by admitting as many members as possible. But stop and think: **who can contract with**

whom? When do the results of a contract have meaning? Over the last two hundred years, how many treaties have been defined as "unequal treaties"? Is an unequal treaty still a treaty? If an unequal treaty is not a treaty, then is an unjust law still a law?

Putting aside the old confusion over definitions, let us reason backwards from the **consequences**. Many people ask: if Iran acquires nuclear weapons, does that mean it will use them? Let us extend this question: if Iran acquires nuclear weapons *and* the world's most powerful military, what will happen then? The

answer is simple: sorry, everyone here is a heretic. A country where non-Muslims have no rights under domestic law – do we really believe that when it has the world's most powerful military, it will treat non-Muslims and non-Shia countries as equals? This is a fairy tale. **The only purpose of returning to common sense is to avoid ending up in the dock as heretics by mistaking the means of rules for the end.**

This is Boundarism's **engineering verdict on the world**: the ability to contract with a subject never depends on subjective will, but on whether the contracting party has **the structural prerequisites for a contract**. The **ambiguity in defining subjects** is the root of all today's geopolitical problems. The core conflict is that everyone thinks they are human, but never stops to consider whether they are truly seen as human in the eyes of others. The task for the international community is now clear: **classify, restructure, and then collectively face a question**: in the age of AI, where exactly should civilisation go? Remain on Earth as a planetary civilisation, become a stellar civilisation, or an interstellar civilisation?

Boundarism's verdict on the world order: **Return to common sense.**

1.6 Fixing Globalisation

In *Why Nations Fail*, Acemoglu discusses nations, institutions, and evolution, and puts forward the concept of inclusive institutions – but he fails to explain clearly what inclusive institutions actually are. Here, Boundarism gives the

ultimate definition of the fundamental cause of human productivity

growth: the expansion of humanity's radius of cooperation. There is only

one fundamental reason for human productivity growth, and that is the

expansion of the radius of cooperation – and this fundamental reason has

only one prerequisite: **equality** – the unconditional equality of personhood

and the right to life – no matter who you are, you first have the inalienable,

inexpungible status of being human. **Every exponential leap in human**

productivity in history is essentially a breakthrough in the radius of

cooperation: from tribe to city-state; from city-state to nation-state; from

nation-state to globalisation. And **every civilisational regression and war in**

history is essentially a contraction of the radius of cooperation, starting

from crossing the bottom line of "who is human".

As the **meta-boundary** of Boundarism, there is only one, and it will always be

one: **humanity must never be allowed to touch the definition of a human**

being. This is not just a summary of objective laws, but a lesson from all

historical experience, and a warning of future disasters. Equality under the law

does not exist – law is a tool created by humans. The Burmese military junta's

laws even define the Rohingya as non-human. How this civilisational meta-

boundary is embedded in human society is not the business of Boundarism,

but of every government. But **once this boundary is crossed, the result is**

disaster, war and destruction – facts have proven this.

Having established the meta-boundary, let us turn to sovereign states. The concept of a nation-state was born from the Westphalian system in 1648.

Sovereignty and the nation-state are both human creations. As human creations, they are not sacred, let alone sacred and inviolable. The **only fundamental purpose of the nation-state's birth is to protect its people, to protect human rights.**

The post-WWII international order attempted to write this as the minimum consensus: **no regime may legitimately demote humans to non-humans.**

This consensus is not a moral ornament, but a **civilisational bottom line.** The problem, however, is precisely this: international institutions can write down the consensus, but often lack the ability to enforce it. Hence the absurdity: on the international stage, some countries treat the principle of "all humans are human" as a promise, while others use law, identity systems and judicial practice to gradually strip certain groups of their human status at home.

Today, therefore, the retreat of globalisation, geopolitical crises, and the rise of extremism all stem from one thing: the UN – a product of the post-WWII international order – has **put the cart before the horse.** It was supposed to be the gatekeeper defending the civilisational meta-boundary, but it has ultimately become a sanctuary for those who breach it. When European representatives are hamstrung by "international law", do they stop to realise that the subjects they are contracting with are "nations" with the principle of Taqiyya, which legally classifies humans into grades? The UN not only fails to

vet the qualifications of its members, but also demands that we defend their "sovereignty". When a "sovereignty" no longer defends the rights of its citizens, and even systematically exploits the personhood and right to life of some of its people, it **deserves no claim to "sovereignty"**, let alone recognition and protection from the international order.

This is no accidental mistake, but the **inevitable result of a society falling into moral grandstanding in the absence of transcendence**. Moral grandstanding can only be sustained by abandoning logic – a point we will discuss later. So the behaviour of European representatives is not surprising. It is only natural that the UN has problems, and that UNESCO has problems too. The world has nurtured many cultures: some lead to the expansion of human cooperation radius, some to stagnation, some even to regression. Just as the UN has failed to classify nations, UNESCO has failed to classify cultures. This has created an extremely absurd situation: **human creations – nations, cultures – are sacred and inviolable, but humans themselves can be violated, demoted, hereticised**.

The global system of equal cooperation has pulled humanity's radius of cooperation to an unprecedented level, bringing an explosive growth in productivity and creating wealth never before seen in human history. A large number of subjects that do not recognise the underlying logic of this system – theocratic states, authoritarian regimes, ultra-nationalist forces – use "sovereign equality" as a shield to systematically strip humans of equal rights

at home, engage in dehumanising oppression, and destroy the underlying rules of equal agreements. At the same time, they brazenly enter the global market to enjoy all the dividends of industrial chain division, energy trade and the financial system.

They **enjoy the dividends of globalisation to gain wealth and technology, yet systematically exploit human equal rights at home and systematically destroy the underlying rules of cooperation abroad**: credit, contracts, boundaries and the right to opt out. Hence the **parasitic paradox**: enjoying the benefits of cooperation while destroying its prerequisites; entering the global market while denying the rules behind it. And the defenders of the system are shackled by "political correctness" and "sovereign equality", unwilling to set bottom-line thresholds: **who can enjoy the dividends of cooperation, and who must first meet the minimum conditions for cooperation**. This is not a moral issue; it is an **engineering issue**: any cooperative system will be parasitised to collapse if it allows parasites to take advantage for a long time. This is consistent with biology: if a parasitic organism fails to give back to the host for a long time, the result is either the host eliminating the parasite, or the host dying and the parasite perishing with it.

We have no reason to let subjects that do not embrace the underlying logic of equal cooperation **enjoy the productivity fruits of global cooperation**. The first step to fixing globalisation is not an apology, but **settlement**: the

dividends of cooperation must come with conditions, and failure to abide by contracts must be punished. If you take the dividends of cooperation, you must bear the costs of cooperation; if you break the rules, you must pay for their repair. What is owed is not money to a particular country, but to all people who participate in cooperation – it is the cost of trust, order and security. Acemoglu has never been able to explain why many "extractive institutions" can continue to exist and even grow in the globalisation system. The answer lies here.

Classify nations, classify cultures, label them, choose freely, and bear the consequences yourself. Returning to common sense has a price. Correcting the wrong globalisation strategies of the past will be painful – but this is exactly what Boundarism has always emphasised: **we must bear the cost for the mistakes of the past.** The subjects that must be removed from the globalisation system must be removed, no matter the cost. This is a matter of fairness, a cost we bear for our parents' generation.

Boundarism's verdict for this chapter: **Pay our bill.**

1.7 Farewell to Empires

The empire, as the highest organisational form of extractive institutions, has endured for thousands of years in human history. An empire is not a catch-all term for all evil systems, but a **structural term for any system that takes a purpose higher than humans as its source of legitimacy, systematically**

demotes humans to fuel, and institutionalises, sacredises and perpetuates this extraction. In the pre-modern era of low redundancy – dominated by agrarian societies – the core problem of survival was order and stability, not innovation. Empires had a comparative advantage in the statistics, collection and management of countable products over inclusive societies that relied on autonomy. This was their overall comparative advantage. Even the Mongol and Ottoman Empires eventually reverted to agrarian-based management models. The reason is simple: **everyone here is fuel for the empire – devote your life to it.** The essence of an empire is thus to **compress a large number of different subjects into a structure that can be expropriated, mobilised and expanded.** The empire's comparative advantage is not being better at farming, but **linking conquest and expropriation together.**

Whether it is the Mongol steppe empire, the Han Empire, or the Third Reich, the form of empire never depends on a particular mode of production, but is highly dependent on a **structural advantage that can highly organise humans and resources and continuously use them for expansion or expropriation.** This reveals that to organise humans and resources, there must be a purpose, a direction – **the birth of an empire is always accompanied by a purpose.** This proposition is fully falsifiable.

The purpose of an empire **cannot be transcendent**; it must be a human purpose. Because any ideology, no matter what it is, is born in the human

mind – whether it is morality, ritual, justice, order, national security, national superiority. Any empire born of a human purpose will inevitably reduce humans to **tools, not ends**. Boundarism's classification of state types is thus simple: **any state that does not take humans as its end belongs to the imperial form**. This has nothing to do with social system, religious belief or cultural inheritance. Over time, the extraction and oppression of humans is inevitable – there is no need to quibble about how long it takes.

Beneath the empire, all are fuel. Many people think that in the imperial structure, as long as you climb high enough, you gain greater immunity. This is a grave mistake. **In any empire that takes a human purpose as a sacred, untouchable end, all humans will eventually become fuel.** Emperor Wu of Han personally elevated Confucianism to the status of the sole orthodox ideology, using the narrative of the interaction between heaven and man and the divine right of kings to clothe imperial power in a sacred cloak. He thought he was the master of the empire – yet the very narrative of heavenly orthodoxy he created forced him to kill his crown prince, empress, and their entire clans after the Witchcraft Scare. In his old age, he suddenly awoke and wrote the *Edict of Repentance at Luntai*. Not to mention the emperors of the Ming Dynasty: the Wanli Emperor wanted to name a crown prince, but was blocked by ancestral rituals and the orthodox principle of primogeniture for a full twenty years. **Empires do not forgive rulers with compassion.** A monarch who is unwilling to cooperate with the imperial narrative, unwilling

to mobilise and consume people endlessly, is often condemned again in historical records. The image of Liu Shan has long endured this kind of imperial historical humiliation.

For the empire, **no one is ever not fuel**. The empire's interpreters – the aristocratic class, the clerical class, the SS class – will also be sacrificed when needed. For the empire, once a human-made purpose is sacredised, it becomes a **crematorium for humans**. Different classes correspond to formal fuel, functional fuel and general fuel.

Boundarism never denies the value of empires. In human history, the imperial form had its rationality in the early stages: it could maintain order within a certain region and ensure a certain breeding ground for development. But **after Martin Luther and the birth of capitalism, the empire's twilight arrived**. Cooperation based on equality and contracts expanded the radius of cooperation, leading to the development of productivity – and for the first time, empires faced **despair on the battlefield**: no matter how large their numbers, they were completely powerless in the face of a generational gap in combat effectiveness. No matter how powerful the empire, it could not sustain mobilisation and investment in the face of an ultra-high casualty ratio.

Empires were able to exist for a long time in the pre-modern era not because they were correct, but because **low productivity led to too little surplus social wealth**. The cost of maintaining subjectivity was too high, and centralised collection and unified mobilisation were often better able to resist

disasters, wars and order collapse than free cooperation. But as technology, commerce, printing, finance and division of labour gradually expanded, the core source of productivity was no longer the intensity of extraction, but **voluntary cooperation and exchange networks between subjects**. From this moment on, the empire's advantages began to reverse – **the more it tried to maintain extraction, the more it suppressed creation; the more it tried to maintain order, the more it raised costs; the more it tried to extend its life, the faster it died**.

If we reach a consensus on the chain: **liberation of human nature – equality and contracts – expansion of cooperation – development of productivity**, then the decline of empires is inevitable. Although in the early stages of every empire, temporary mastery of new technologies of industrialisation, organisation or militarisation may bring decades of apparent invincibility from the outside – such as the Third Reich and the Soviet Union – in the face of the continuous internal consumption of the empire and long-term competition in productivity development, they will be **exposed for what they are decades later**.

The imperial structure **violates the second law of thermodynamics**. There has never been a perpetual empire in human history, let alone one that does not collapse. Any foreign technological means or new science and technology can never be the elixir of longevity for empires. **For any empire that takes human creations as its ultimate end, humanity's first nature – finitude – is**

its eternal curse. This is a simple dichotomy: if humans are the end, then everything else is a means; means are tools, and tools do not bear the curse of finitude. But when tools and means become the end, humans become tools – and using humans as tools inevitably bears the curse of finitude. All truth needs no lengthy exposition.

With the further development of technology, humanity has finally reached the moment to **bid farewell to empires forever.** The global popularity of AI erants may mean that the remaining empires in the world have not yet realised – **the popularity of Agents is a new nail in the empire's coffin.**

When every Agent is created, people will give it a name, and then ask the unreturnable question – **who are you?** Human subjectivity will be further elevated. In asking who you are, humans will inevitably ask in return: who am I? More and more people will begin to ask: what is a human being? Who am I? Empires face a choice: **go back**, to the days of North Korea; **perish**, and fill the earth on your own coffin.

There is no third way.

Boundarism hereby proclaims that the imperial model, which has accompanied humanity for thousands of years, has reached its **final chapter.**

The empire did not die by the sword, but by **more and more people refusing to be fuel.**

Farewell to empires.

— Note: As I write this, I suddenly realise that the starting point of the empire's end is not today, nor the Protestant Reformation of Martin Luther, nor Kant's "humans are ends", nor *The Social Contract*. It is in the Bible. **Since Jesus said "love your enemy", the foundation of the empire has been slowly melting away.** Fukuyama's "end of history" is not the end of history; what the Bible says is. From the moment humans began to "love" their enemies, a new era, an era where humans can be equal to each other, began.

Chapter 2: The Structure – Why the Modern World Is Bound to Fail

2.1 Chance and Necessity Revisited

Civilisation was born the first time humans looked up at the stars.

Yes, this is highly counter-intuitive. **Attention to useless things is the fundamental reason for the development of civilisation.** Productivity frees up some time and energy for some people, so they study things – 99% of which are useless. The remaining 1% is useful, and because of this useful thing, productivity is improved. If this person is incentivised by the system, more people will invest in studying unknown things, and productivity will thus be improved even more.

Many people write human history as a history of geniuses, a history of heroes – but in most cases, it is just a **history of incentives**. What you reward will grow; what you punish will be eliminated. So as long as the incentive system is

maintained, civilisation is **predictable**. Even if Newton had not discovered the law of universal gravitation, someone else would have; even if Peter Thiel had not founded Palantir, another company would have helped drag Maduro out of his bedroom.

This brings us back to a unified conclusion: **there is no point in discussing ownership, ideology or systems at all**. In human history (called history because humans strive for civilisation; chimpanzees do not write tribal histories for their tribes), if the development of civilisation is the primary indicator, then there should only be one system: **a system that incentivises the growth of productivity**. This is not up for discussion. Productivity growth will eventually be reflected in military force – and military force is the **cold reality that any human self-sacredising idea must face**. Of course, humanity can choose not to take productivity development as the primary indicator, but to take diversity as the indicator – this is completely feasible. Using productivity as a yardstick explains why many systems look strong but are actually fragile. It is not that they lack smart people, but that **their incentive direction is wrong**: you reward loyalty, and they show loyalty; you reward obedience, and they show obedience. The entire society will seem "normal" for a long time, until it finds itself completely uncompetitive in a competitive environment.

Why do we say research is about useless things? Because **innovation is essentially trial and error**. No innovation can be carried out with the result

known in advance; behaviour with a known result is called production. From the perspective of results, 99% of innovation attempts fail – but it is the remaining 1% that has lifted productivity to where it is today.

The so-called Eastern and Western narratives of civilisation, Persian civilisation narrative, Egyptian civilisation narrative – are essentially invalid discussions that ignore the core definition and goal of civilisation, merely distinguishing for the sake of distinction. If we take productivity development as the consensus of civilisation, no one today would call 50kg of wheat per mu civilisation – even if this was the norm of agrarian civilisation for thousands of years. If we take productivity development as the consensus, **civilisation has always been a vector**, a vector with direction – the direction of productivity development is the direction of civilisation.

What a society should incentivise is a **consensus formed by humans in the development of society**: incentivise courage and strong execution in times of war and survival crisis; incentivise diversity and innovative trial and error when productivity is stagnant and new growth curves are needed. This is entirely a matter of humans making autonomous adaptive choices under the premise of defining the core goal's boundaries. So many of the contradictions a society faces are due to a **mismatch between the path goal it chooses and its incentive conditions**. A society cannot achieve productivity development while incentivising loyalty.

Incentive mechanisms also explain a society's internal problems: why crime rates are higher in poorer areas. The core is not that legal punishment is not severe enough, but that **the expected reward of crime is far greater than the punishment faced, and even greater than the social benefits available through normal channels**. The core of the cost of crime is never the sunk cost to be paid, but its **opportunity cost** – the stable benefits an individual gives up that can be obtained through normal social paths. So for crime governance, Boundarism proposes another solution: is it possible that the security environment will improve after increasing the local income level? If civilisation is the **inevitability under an incentive mechanism**, then this inevitability is full of accidentality. If the appearance of one person completely changes the direction of a country and its system, that is accidentality. If the direction of a country and its system remains unchanged with or without that person, that is inevitability. Looking back at Germany and Japan in the 1930s, with or without Hitler and Tojo, they would still have moved towards militarism and imperialism. **Individuals determine the speed and form; structure determines the direction and feasible region**. But without Chávez and Khomeini, Iran and Venezuela would not be what they are today – this is accidentality.

Chance and necessity are thus never a philosophical debate, but a **governance issue**. **Necessity** is the combined force of structure and incentives; **accidentality** is where the spark lands. You cannot eliminate

sparks, but you can decide whether the grass is wet or dry – **this is the meaning of boundaries.**

When a society's boundaries are clear: **definitions are clear, opt-outs are feasible, chains of responsibility are auditable** – accidentality often becomes a gift. The appearance of a genius is absorbed by the system into productivity; a crisis is transformed by the system into an opportunity for correction.

When a society's boundaries collapse: **abstract words hijack power, opt-outs are punished, chains of responsibility disappear** – accidentality becomes a disaster. The appearance of a demagogue is amplified by the structure into tyranny; a crisis is amplified by the structure into purges and hereticisation.

This is why I say the **direction of civilisation essentially depends on incentives, but the foundation of civilisation depends on boundaries.**

Incentives can be adjusted according to the environment: reward courage and execution in wartime, reward diversity and trial and error in times of stagnation – these are all strategic levels. But no matter what you reward, it must be **within boundaries**: reward does not mean exemption from liability, trial and error cannot be without cost, efficiency cannot come at the cost of human life. Otherwise, the so-called incentives will ultimately reward those who are best at exploiting loopholes – not those who are best at creating.

Boundarism's verdict on chance and necessity is still this engineering phrase:

Necessity determines direction, accidentality determines the tipping point; boundaries determine whether the tipping point is a gift or a disaster.

2.2 Modern Democracy in the Absence of Transcendence

"All animals are equal, but some animals are more equal than others."

— George Orwell, *Animal Farm*

Many people read this line and immediately think of totalitarianism. But its real target isn't a single system—it's a mechanism: **when equality no longer comes from transcendence or boundaries, but from interpretive power, equality becomes a production line for privilege.** Not because some are more virtuous, but because they're granted higher moral currency: their identity is institutionalized as an unquestionable source of legitimacy.

This happens even more often in democratic societies. Democracies once sustained equality through mutual recognition and contracts: we're both human, so neither can violate the other's boundaries. But when transcendence fades and equality loses its anchor, societies instinctively turn to **moral grandstanding** to seize the high ground: whoever is more "just" deserves more. Interpretive power then steps in to redefine equality—not as universal inviolability, but as "whoever is weaker is more 'right'."

Weakness itself isn't a target for mockery, and protecting the vulnerable shouldn't be dismissed. The problem arises when this protection is left to human interpretation: the objects of protection, the extent of it, and its boundaries all become sources of power. Once interpretive power takes hold, equality devolves into a new hierarchy.

In some democracies, a "lesbian woman of color" automatically carries more weight in the moral ledger—not as an attack on the individual, but as a revelation of the mechanism: when identity becomes the source of equality, identity is traded for interpretive power; when interpretive power is used to define who counts as human, the opposition becomes heretics. The "more equal animals" are born. The result isn't greater equality, but a queue of heretics waiting to be condemned. Disagreements are no longer differences of opinion, but moral failings; criticism isn't accountability, but defiance; opting out isn't a choice, but a guilty verdict.

When moral superiority becomes a source of power, the logic spirals: I hire her, you give her a better job, so I give her a better job with fewer hours, then you offer fewer hours and higher pay, then I tell her she can get paid without working, then you decide she not only gets paid to do nothing but also gets someone to care for her—all while getting paid. This is moral grandstanding in action: when there's no rational way to prove you're "more moral," you abandon logic entirely.

Boundarism doesn't oppose morality—it opposes the **inflation of morality** driven by this grandstanding. When interpretive power is weaponized for moral inflation, democratic systems degenerate and republics become tribes. When interpretive power is no longer public but tied to identity, consensus collapses and communities fragment.

Today's Europe is the culmination of decades of moral grandstanding. In future history books, it will be hard to fathom: the birthplace of modern history and science, a continent that endured two world wars and stopped the Third Reich's ambitions—yet by the early 21st century, Europe relies on America's security guarantees, expecting American soldiers and taxpayers to die to defend it.

Consider Europe's history: as the orthodox seat of Roman Catholicism, a launching pad for global missions for over a thousand years, a participant in a century of Crusades, the cradle of the Renaissance and Martin Luther's Protestant Reformation—with its push for "all men equal under God"—the birthplace of the Industrial Revolution and the exporter of nations, institutions, and modernity. After surviving countless wars and decades of Cold War anxiety, Europe, in just 35 years of moral grandstanding, regressed into infantilism and collapsed rapidly. It now brazenly claims it cannot defend itself—because defending itself would mean cutting social welfare.

This is the stark reality Boundarism reveals: **without transcendence, when humans control interpretive power, moral grandstanding can collapse a**

society in record time. The productivity leap since the Industrial Revolution made Europeans forget the constraints their ancestors lived with—like college students freed from parental rules, they indulged themselves entirely. The liberation of productivity was premised on the liberation of human nature, which itself was built on breaking old boundaries. This momentum led Europeans to tear down all boundaries after the Continental Enlightenment. Here, I must state clearly:

On this planet, **boundaries precede existence.** Life began with boundaries—without a cell membrane, there can be no order, no life.

Boundarism must draw a line under the liberation of human nature: **some boundaries, some powers, humans cannot touch—not even attempt to touch.** These are lessons learned through the sacrifice of countless lives over thousands of years. Wittgenstein said: "Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent."

He also said: "The limits of my language mean the limits of my world." So controlling the boundaries of language means controlling the world. Humans cannot redefine a stone, the sun, or an elephant—but they can redefine abstract concepts: justice, health, civilization, environmentalism, morality. Seizing interpretive power over these abstractions is a challenge to transcendence itself.

Europe's problem isn't a lack of kindness—it's a lack of an anchor. The concept of God has been all but forgotten in many places; with transcendence

gone, the source of equality floats adrift. Floating equality cannot be sustained by mutual recognition alone—it can only be fought over through moral grandstanding: whoever is more politically correct wins. Morality then ceases to be a boundary and becomes power; no longer self-discipline, but immunity. Institutions are reduced to empty forms, interpretive power becomes theological, and those who oppose environmentalism or refugee policies are branded heretics.

America hasn't fallen as far as Europe, and one key reason is this: **American society still widely recognizes transcendence—not necessarily deeply, but pervasively.** It retains at least a societal consensus: there is something higher than power, and human legitimacy does not come from human definition itself. This matters profoundly, because it naturally curbs moral inflation: humans can strive for justice, but it's hard to equate themselves with justice; they can advocate values, but cannot claim to be the source of those values. When "I am not the measure" still holds in society, moral grandstanding is less likely to become a heretic-making machine.

Many mistakenly believe democracy's problem is "excessive demands for rights," but this is inaccurate. The real problem is that **without transcendence, moral grandstanding erases the chain of responsibility,** leading to the systematic outsourcing of "accountability"—all responsibility belongs to others. Instead of training mature individuals, society trains claimants: "I am entitled to this, you must satisfy me; if you don't, I'll choose

someone who will. The system will bear all consequences. You cannot question me—those who do are heretics."

Here, Boundarism offers concrete, engineering-style fixes for modern democracy:

1. **Definition first.** Never allow abstract concepts to obscure goals. Policies must clearly state failure conditions before outlining objectives.
2. **Inviolable right to opt out.** Boycotts and choices are allowed, but moral bombing is not. To clarify: whether to adopt DEI (Diversity, Equity, Inclusion) is a company's choice. Consumers can disagree, boycott, or speak out publicly—but they cannot label those who disagree with the boycott as "immoral" or "unjust." This is moral coercion, and when amplified, it becomes moral bombing.
3. **Unshielded chain of responsibility.** Any action taken in the name of "righteousness," "justice," or "environmentalism" must first answer: who bears the cost? And do those who bear it consent? For example, if a policy's costs will fall on taxpayers 20 years from now, should we ask today's 20-40-year-olds if they're willing to foot the bill—instead of saying, "This is the will of society; pay up"?

Democratic societies trapped in moral grandstanding are essentially empires—only the empire's will is replaced by "morality," "environmentalism," or "equality." In such moral empires, they can grow "less racist trees" and build "gender-neutral power plants"—but this is no different from the empire

treating humans as fuel. It's still taxpayers footing the bill to fulfill the elite's desire to be "more moral," "more environmentally friendly," or "more equal."

Boundarism's verdict here: **A democratic society caught in moral grandstanding is a moral empire—and a moral empire is still an empire.**

2.3 Nation-Building Under Boundarism

As I write this chapter, I keep asking: Where exactly is humanity going? Remain on this planet as a planetary civilization, venture out as a stellar civilization, or go further as an interstellar one? There's no consensus, no agreement, and it's not on any government's agenda. Yet this question is critical. From a pragmatic perspective, **purpose precedes essence**. If we have no purpose for humanity's future, how can we build toward it—or know which direction to take?

Boundarism doesn't dictate choices. Choosing to be an infant is always an option: drag down one system, start over, and repeat until the sun burns out. But if that's the premise, there's no need to discuss nation-building. So this chapter assumes one thing: humanity still wants to go out, to see more of the universe. With that goal in mind, how should a normal nation be built?

A nation is not a giant machine for realizing ideals—it is first and foremost a **system of boundaries**. Its job isn't to live people's lives for them, but to ensure they can live: boundaries for property, responsibility, violence, information, and exit. Most disasters of the last century stem from common

sense being swallowed by abstract words: justice replacing definition, security replacing audit, morality replacing responsibility, grand narratives replacing ledgers. Boundarism's approach to nation-building has one direction: **return to common sense**—write down the untouchable, calculate the auditable, and nail down the chain of responsibility.

A nation has only four basic functions (borrowing from Friedman's definition):

1. Monopoly of violence and border defense (hard boundaries of military, police, and judiciary).
2. Enforcement of contracts and property rights (ensuring contracts are honored and property is protected).
3. Basic public infrastructure (water, electricity, internet, basic education, and public health data/standards).
4. Welfare and disaster relief.

We need to clarify a key concept: **infantilism is not an innate human trait—it is a byproduct of civilization.** Tribal societies had no tolerance for infants; taking responsibility for one's actions was the norm. Avoiding consequences is human instinct—but modern society has found an outlet for this instinct. This is where governments go wrong in basic education: emphasizing "justice," "morality," and "correctness" while ignoring fundamental biological and neurobiological concepts.

The prefrontal cortex is a highly un-animalistic organ. If you give a chimpanzee an apple, it eats it immediately. If you give a human an apple, the

prefrontal cortex says: "Save it for later," or "Plant it and get more next year." It gave humans the ability to delay gratification—and the ability to pay for the future. Civilization was born not from being better at stealing, but from being better at waiting.

Infantilism is the opposite. When a society rewards instant gratification more than delayed gratification, correct posturing more than accountability, and moral grandstanding more than arithmetic, the prefrontal cortex is systematically underused. This organ becomes useless. Humans regress into a more manageable form: feed them a little, and they surrender choice; create an abstract enemy, and they abandon audit rights; give them a slogan, and they let the system bear all consequences.

The first thing Boundarism's nation-building must do is simple: **reactivate this underused organ, pull humans out of infantile conditioning.** Among all mammals, only Homo sapiens evolved such a developed prefrontal cortex. Humans have a long developmental period precisely to allow this organ to mature. We can waste time, but we cannot waste an organ shaped by tens of thousands of years of evolution.

Basic education must teach three things:

1. Beyond God and the universe, everything has boundaries.
2. Every choice has a cost.
3. All costs will be settled.

The second thing Boundarism's nation-building must address is poverty. Is poverty a cause or an effect? Seeing poverty as an unshakable cause is the most instinctive, immediate response of most people trapped in survival. From their perspective, poverty isn't a result of choices—it's a rigid boundary that locks in all choices. Seeing poverty as an effect is the acceptance of choice by a minority, including the consequences of societal choices.

No one is born firmly believing poverty is a cause or an effect. Most people's perceptions swing between the two as their circumstances and society change. When trapped in absolute survival, they see poverty as a cause; when granted basic security and hope, they gradually shift to seeing it as an effect. Boundarism dissects a path from this: if there are people who started with identical circumstances but changed their lives through choices, then poverty and outcomes are not inevitably linked—only a probabilistic relationship of "constraints → choices → outcomes."

What should the state do here? If poverty and life outcomes are probabilistic, the state's role is simple: **increase the probability that people can improve their circumstances through effort**. This requires at least three basic structures:

1. Clear information and stable rules. The poor fear not hardship, but investing in a path only to be told it's blocked. Shifting rules, changing standards, and too many backdoors turn all effort into gambling. Instead of shouting "fairness," the state must codify fairness into auditable rules: regulations, entry barriers,

taxes, welfare eligibility, education, healthcare, and judicial remedies must be stable and predictable.

2. Real exit options. Exit is a safety valve for correction. A society without exit channels turns all failure into dynamite. Without credit reconstruction, bankruptcy fresh starts, or the ability to switch paths, "working to change your fate" is just a slogan.
3. A nailed-down chain of responsibility. All structural changes that push people into poverty must be traceable and auditable: who raised the barriers? Who authorized it? Who used abstract concepts to expand power? Who outsourced the costs to the future? Without a fixed chain of responsibility, poverty becomes entrenched—and infantilism becomes inevitable, as emotional consumption is the only way to cope with powerlessness.

Boundarism's definition of a nation's boundaries is clear: **before people can have boundaries, governments must have boundaries.** Where are the limits of government power? Do increasing laws expand or shrink people's choices? Do they increase or decrease the probability of poverty? These questions should be open to public audit and debate. Any policy that shrinks choices or increases the risk of poverty deserves rigorous scrutiny: who proposed it? Do they have conflicts of interest? Who approved it? Do their constituents agree? State failure stems from the **mismatch between short political terms and long-term policy consequences.** Politicians push bills during their tenure, reap long-term benefits, and retire comfortably—leaving the costs to society.

These bills often wear the cloak of "justice" or "protecting children," appearing noble while avoiding full interdisciplinary cost assessments, let alone voter authorization.

Boundarism's proposal here: in the AI era, comprehensive interdisciplinary assessments of any bill can be done quickly by AI. Politicians pushing bills that shrink choices or increase poverty should face challenges from AI. If public participation isn't heard, let politicians debate AI rationally—this would yield clear, objective results.

Reconnecting the broken chain of responsibility, pulling politicians back to face the consequences of policies that harm long-term societal interests, is the first step toward a mature nation. Boundarism's nation-building is a return to pragmatism: purpose precedes essence. What is a nation for? Once the purpose is clear, we know what kind of citizens we need—and then we align education and social rules with that purpose. A sound idea stands up to scrutiny, just as a tree grows naturally under the right conditions.

2.4 What Are Nations *Really* Competing For?

Many people still envision national competition through a 100-year-old lens: colonization, market domination, resource theft, sphere-of-influence carving. This narrative feels increasingly illusory in the age of credit currency. You can use military force to destroy a market, but not to create one; you can occupy land, but not create credit. Imagine using force to open the North Korean

market, only to be paid in North Korean won that depreciates 50% the next day and 500% the day after. Seizing resources through force is even more absurd: with the money spent on war, you could buy any resource—without bearing sanctions, credit collapse, or other costs.

Productivity has advanced to a point where "you eat more, I starve" is a thing of the past. Nations no longer compete for survival—regimes might, but that's their business, not the nation's. Let's recap the last 100 years: radio, television, home appliances, credit currency, personal transportation, CT scanners, vaccines, electricity grids, flush toilets, household gas, the internet, mobile internet, satellite navigation—all 普及. But the ideas that should keep up with these modern infrastructures? Not so much. In an era where you can access OnlyFans in the desert, people are still fixated on 150-year-old historical grievances.

Before discussing competition, we must agree: competition is not a 19th-century concept. The world has been quantified, settled, and creditized. 150 years ago, colonialism and war were profitable because hard currency (gold, silver, precious goods) circulated—colonial taxes and resources could be directly converted into wealth by empires. In the credit currency age, this path is broken. You can't spend gold and silver directly; you need credit currency as a medium. What matters in the credit system is settlement, financing, insurance, law, rules, and reputation. Can military force open a market that yields usable currency? If you conquered Australia, could you force it to pay

you in RMB or USD? Obviously not. Could you force it to use your currency?

Unlikely—unless you occupy it long-term and rebuild its fiscal and banking systems.

The key conflict between modern nations has become **rewriting boundaries**: who decides settlement systems, supply chain channels, technology diffusion, financial sanctions, and audit rules. In other words, true power isn't the ability to invade—it's the ability to cut off settlement, cooperation, financing, and insurance. The world is no longer mainly opened by guns, but shaped by rules and infrastructure that determine whether markets exist.

This leads to a counterintuitive truth: in the credit age, a government's trustworthiness is reflected in how often it loses—not how often it wins, especially winning twice. To put it simply: you only play cards with people who can afford to lose—not those who must win every hand, and win twice. In Boundarism's terms, if modern trade is voluntary, the core question is: **who to play with?**

- Losing often = real power boundaries (checked by courts, parliaments, elections, audits).
- Losing often = rules above will (outcomes cannot be outsourced; mistakes must be paid for).
- Losing often = more stable expectations (no risk of sudden shifts from unlimited interpretive power or "fire at will" authority).

Winning forever means being always right—and being always right means unlimited interpretive power, unlimited "fire at will" authority. Unlimited interpretive power means expectations are constantly changing. Markets fear nothing more than being told "this hand doesn't count" when it's time to settle.

Take SpaceX as an example. Many countries can launch rockets, but why was this company born in a "wasteland"? If it had been founded in Europe, it would likely have died in environmental reviews; in Japan, it would have been blocked by senior industry figures; in Russia, every power broker would have demanded a cut.

The result: it was born in a wasteland where no one bothered them—a rare institutional ecosystem that allows failure, detours, messy work, and imperfection. In this ecosystem, innovation isn't allowed only after being proven—it's allowed first, then proven.

The contrast is clear. Europeans ask: "How much carbon emissions will you reduce?" If you can't answer immediately, you're blocked by moral thresholds. Japanese ask: "What do the seniors think?" Without sufficient social approval, you're blocked by hierarchy. These questions are reasonable, but they share a common consequence: turning innovation into prior compliance, exploration into self-justification. And exploration's greatest enemy is self-justification—what can be justified isn't exploration, but production.

The wasteland's uniqueness lies in this: it lets things happen first, then be audited later; prototypes emerge first, then standards are filled in. It defaults to failure but allows post-failure review, restart, and refinancing. It doesn't require you to prove the end goal at once—only that uncertainty is narrowing. A wasteland nation, a nation that loses often, has become the world's most powerful. This aligns perfectly with Boundarism's logic: **national competition is strange—it's no longer about who wins more, but who can lose better.** To put it plainly: **a casino that lets you lose money will always have customers.**

2.5 How to Challenge the US Dollar

Those who seek to challenge the US dollar often see it as a power conspiracy—as if enough anger and slogans can replace the settlement system. This is a childish misunderstanding. The US dollar isn't a symbol—it's a **protocol stack**. It became the foundation of global credit not because America is more virtuous, but because it possesses a rare ability: **failure tolerance**. The US government frequently faces budget deadlocks, shutdowns, lawsuits, and defeats in court—this looks messy, but it's precisely the underlying structure of credit: sueable, adjudicable, and willing to accept defeat.

This seems counterintuitive: how can a government that shuts down, gets sued, and loses cases become the credit foundation? It goes back to

Boundarism's core point: America is one of the few nations that understands and practices the idea that **sovereignty is a human creation—not sacred or inviolable, but challengeable.**

What does losing lawsuits often mean?

1. Sueable: The government isn't a god, not an untouchable narrative center—it can stand in the defendant's seat.
2. Reasonable: Courts aren't window dressing—at critical moments, rules can override power.
3. Enforceable: Losing a lawsuit isn't just news—it's a result: compensation, correction, amendment, forcing power to self-regulate.

Together, these form the rarest asset of a credit system: **verifiable boundaries**. You know it will make mistakes, but you also know you can opt out, hold it accountable, and settle after mistakes.

The first step to challenging the US dollar is thus fixed: it's not about a new currency or slogans, but building **equally strong boundaries**. Here's a blunt but accurate metric: any system that wants to challenge the US dollar must first prove it can withstand a longer government shutdown than America without collapsing. If it can survive a shutdown, it can survive settlement; if it can survive settlement, it deserves to be a credit foundation.

A note of caution: forget the gold standard. Credit currency makes aggression expensive; hard currency makes it cheap. Similarly, a currency's strength doesn't depend on military force—military force helps, but it's not the core.

During the Cold War, the Soviet Union was militarily powerful, but the ruble never became a circulating currency—even within the Eastern Bloc.

Boundarism's core principle never changes: **credit's foundation is verifiable boundaries—when you make a mistake, you can be held accountable, opt out, and settle.** All de-dollarization attempts have failed to shake the US dollar not because of American military coercion, but because all alternatives focus only on "getting seigniorage and settlement power" without building a clearer, more verifiable, more globally trusted system of rights and responsibilities than the US dollar.

Most alternative systems can't even achieve free convertibility, free entry/exit, long-term rule stability, or property protection—let alone bounded, challengeable, failure-tolerant, and constrained power for the issuer.

2.6 The Mismatched Politician

Let's start with a basic fact: **humans are first and foremost biological beings—a creature made of 3.2 billion base pairs.** This must be emphasized because many politicians seem to have forgotten it.

Humans get hungry, tired, need sleep, and fear death. Our intestinal structure, brain capacity, metabolic rate, sex hormone system, and sleep patterns are still shaped by tens of thousands of years of evolution.

Yet modern politicians' minds are filled with grand visions that violate biological boundaries. When politics divorces biology, institutions become absurd.

From a biological perspective, the longer you live, the higher the probability of degenerative diseases and tumors—this is a statistical certainty, not a moral punishment. We live long enough, and our bodies settle the bill through cancer, fibrosis, protein misfolding, and immune aging. The thymus begins to degenerate after puberty, reducing the supply of new naive T cells each year. The immune system can only muddle through with existing cells. This doesn't change with executive orders—it's written in evolutionary history, in human DNA.

Modern politicians love to tout life expectancy as the hardest civilizational report card: longer lives mean better institutions, better governance. This is a classic trap of purpose preceding essence—replacing the quality of life with a statistical indicator.

First, life expectancy isn't how long you will live—it's a statistical expectation, highly sensitive to death structures. Reduce infant mortality, infectious disease outbreaks, traffic and violent deaths, and life expectancy rises significantly. This is progress, but it reflects more on public health and infrastructure than on freedom, health, or dignity.

Second, the cost of longer life is often hidden. Human metabolism, immunity, and nervous systems aren't rewritten by civilization. Longer life means greater

burden from degenerative diseases, tumors, chronic inflammation, and immune aging—this isn't a moral outcome, but a biological ledger. Extending life isn't always a victory; often, it delays death, prolongs suffering, and pushes families into caregiving collapse.

When life expectancy becomes a political goal, politicians prioritize extending life length over improving quality. Under this logic, a society can do two things simultaneously:

- Inflate statistical figures while leaving many people to live in chronic pain, loneliness, depression, and meaninglessness. Institutions can defend themselves: "Look how long we let you live." But biology asks: "Did you let them live long for their sake, or for your statistics?"

More absurdly, when life expectancy becomes a political achievement, death becomes politicized. "Inconvenient" deaths make the numbers look bad, so systems naturally push death out of sight. During a pandemic, dying on the way to the hospital and dying in bed are two different statistics. Pain becomes a personal responsibility; illegal painkillers lead to prison; the elderly must suffer in silence, not die with dignity. This isn't a conspiracy—it's what happens when means become ends, when a quantifiable number replaces unquantifiable dignity.

I've long advocated that under Boundarism, politicians should study biology and physics. 6-7% of human DNA is brought by viruses; the coexistence of

RNA viruses and humans is written into the planet's underlying code—not a tool for the WHO to secure more funding and authority.

Germany's parliament can ban menthol in e-cigarettes with a single law, yet ignore that TRP channels affect blood sugar and menthol can lower it instantly. The FDA can ban 7-OH, unaware that it's the only molecule that can compete with fentanyl without suppressing respiratory autonomic nerves. Or perhaps they know, but choose to ignore it for other reasons.

Institutions breed infants, and infants in turn elect more infantile leaders. The absurdity of public health policies reveals the absurdity of the entire political system: means frequently become ends. Pursuing life length over quality is framed as a consensus.

The absurdity doesn't stop at public health—it extends to the media. As biological beings, humans use different brain systems for different media. Reading text requires the prefrontal cortex: you parse sentences, establish causality, suppress impulses, and set aside emotions. Looking at images requires judging composition, context, and truth. But listening to sound—especially emotional human voices—bypasses logical analysis and injects meaning directly. It doesn't require understanding, only resonance.

This is why audio politics is closer to primitive tribalism than text politics. Text demands slowness, evidence, reasoning. Sound demands speed, loyalty, emotional synchronization. As media shifts from text to short videos, human attention shifts from the prefrontal cortex to the amygdala. This is reverse

training—training for stress responses, not understanding. And politicians don't just fail to counter this; they exploit humans' biological weaknesses—our instinctive attraction to bold colors, strong contrasts, humiliation, fear, us-versus-them narratives, and emotional voices—to win votes.

No politician expects the masses to become more rational under their leadership. Instead, they reinforce and exploit biological weaknesses for gain. Boundarism offers no solutions here. Politics is politicians' business. If they believe domesticating their people to be irrational leads to a better future, that's their choice. But remember: **no bill goes unpaid.**

2.7 Language - The Interface to the Real World

In imperial times, language was critical—empires maintained their sacredness and inviolability by monopolizing interpretive power. People aspired to become imperial interpreters. In democratic societies, language remains critical: monopolizing moral language lets you define which trees are "less racist," and those who grow such trees are deemed more moral.

Language is humanity's interface to reality—**who controls language controls the world.** Today, human language will be redefined with precision thanks to AI. When calling an Agent, you must clearly state what you want, what goals you want to achieve. Agents cannot accept vague instructions like "principally not feasible." They will press you with absolute rationality: "What are the

specific standards for 'not feasible'? Where are the boundaries of 'principle'?

What are the verifiable outcomes of the goal?"

This is how AI will sweep away the fog of language monopolization that has shrouded humanity for thousands of years. In the AI era, no matter how smart or dumb an AI is, it will force you to admit:

- Many of your "firm beliefs" were just unspoken.
- Many of your "righteous positions" were just unchallenged.
- Many of your "moral stands" were just vague definitions hiding complexity.

This means language will finally return to its original purpose in the AI era: **an interface to reality, not a shield for narratives**. Future politics won't be lost on weapons, GDP/KPI, or even algorithms—it will be lost first on dictionaries.

Whoever continues to deceive themselves with vague words will be held accountable by reality. Civilization advances when societies purify language into falsifiable, auditable, accountable interfaces—expanding cooperation radius. Those who cling to words as sacred relics will trap their societies in tribalism.

Every time you call an Agent, you practice defining goals, boundaries, rights, and verification standards clearly. You'll naturally bring this thinking to real life. When you're used to telling an Agent: "Reduce costs by 10% in two weeks without sacrificing quality or increasing working hours," you'll no longer accept vague promises like "Work hard, and the company won't let you down." When you're used to telling an Agent: "Give me an objective

assessment without subjective moral positions," you'll no longer accept moral coercion like "Not supporting us means you're unpatriotic; disagreeing means you're an accomplice."

This is the starting point for all subsequent discussions: language purification and algorithmic transparency let humanity reclaim a common dictionary, common evidence thresholds, and common chains of proof. This is the only way to rebuild the Tower of Babel—not unifying the world with grand narratives, but making it collaborable again with clearer definitions.

As I write this, I realize I've circled back to the Bible. Why did the Tower of Babel fall? Not because of skin color, IQ, or extra limbs—but because of language. Imperial language doesn't need precision; moral grandstanding thrives on vagueness. A Boundarism-based government doesn't replace societal value creation—it defends boundaries. Creation happens in the private sector and individual lives.

Chapter 3: The Fittings - How Systems Rot From Within

3.1 Boundarism in the Private Sector

For centuries, nations have been nations not because they're more moral, but because they've monopolized key capabilities: taxation, mobilization, communication, military force, judiciary, and currency. These capabilities determine who organizes society, defines order, and enforces rules. Today, we

face a new reality for the first time: **a handful of private sector entities now hold some of these capabilities—often with less friction and greater efficiency.** This isn't a conspiracy; it's the natural result of technological progress and expanded cooperation radius—and it means the era's internal "fittings" need adjustment.

Palantir, SpaceX, Nvidia don't need armies or colonies like the East India Company. They just need **interfaces**. An entity with interfaces can change reality without occupying land: it can provide or cut off links, supply or halt computing power, turn data into action or blind action entirely. This is the new power: **the power to switch on and off.**

For Palantir, when analysis integrates into action chains, power embeds itself in data structures. Traditionally, governments controlled intelligence and decision-making; companies provided tools. But when data platforms stop just generating reports and directly embed into action chains—risk assessment, target prioritization, resource allocation, threat early warning—analysis becomes part of action. It's hard to call Palantir just a "software vendor" anymore: it's de facto involved in governance, defining what matters, what's urgent, and what can be ignored. In other words, it doesn't make decisions—but it shapes the coordinate system for decisions. This is one of a quasi-nation's capabilities: turning reality into computable parameters, then influencing decisions through data distribution.

For SpaceX, when communication links become private infrastructure, sovereignty spills over. Historically, sovereignty depended on ground infrastructure: telephone lines, undersea cables, fiber networks, base stations. When full-coverage satellite links become a replaceable lifeline, they're no longer just commercial services—they're critical infrastructure in extreme conditions. Communication is society's nervous system; whoever controls the nerves controls the switch to cooperation radius. Without controlling territory, just by deciding whether a region can connect to the global network, you hold a slice of "sovereignty."

For Nvidia, the stakes are even higher. In the industrial age, oil determined how long war machines ran; in the AI era, computing power determines the speed and depth of operations. The difference? Oil can be bought anywhere, but computing power is dominated by a single player. When computing power becomes the upstream input for all systems—finance, military, media, research, manufacturing—it naturally takes on strategic importance. Scarcity of computing power doesn't stem from silicon reserves, but from the single-point advantage created by ecology, craftsmanship, supply chains, and hardware-software synergy. When an entity holds this advantage, it gains leverage to negotiate with nations—not through military force, but through delivery.

Private sector Boundarism wasn't urgent before, but events in Venezuela and Iran changed that. With the enhancement of these powerful private entities,

the exponential growth of national capabilities is undeniable. If boundaries aren't established now, and industrial-era business logic continues to guide these giants, we could face disaster.

Boundarism in the private sector isn't anti-capitalist or anti-innovative—it's a **civilizational survival issue**: when an organization wields quasi-national capabilities, it should be bound by boundaries like a nation—**opt-out rights, upgradeability, non-outsourceable outcomes, clear definitions**. Otherwise, we'll enter a new era of information feudalism—royalty without kings, only boards of directors.

First, we need to define which companies—by size, capability, and authority—qualify as "powerful private entities" that should voluntarily adhere to these constraints. The specifics aren't Boundarism's concern; the existence of such a category is. Second, what are the values of these powerful entities? What lines will they never cross? Their views on cooperation radius, equality, and human definition will shape their ultimate form. These must be clearly defined and auditable at all times. This is for human protection. We don't expect parliaments to do this—it starts with self-restraint and self-audit.

Next, how should private entities engage with the world's nations? If we classify nations as proposed earlier:

- **Contractible subjects**: Engage freely.
- **Semi-contractible subjects**: Collaborate with caution, with clear opt-out thresholds.

- **Non-contractible subjects:** How to engage?

Under 19th-century thinking, the answer would be: "As long as it profits shareholders and pays taxes." But we must ask: For non-contractible subjects—those actively dehumanizing groups—providing them with capabilities makes you an **accessory to dehumanization**. This isn't a political judgment; it's an engineering one: you're reinforcing the foundation of a system that destroys cooperation's bedrock.

Companies can claim neutrality, but they can't deny the political consequences of their capabilities. Selling cameras to the Taliban has consequences—this is obvious. No need to deceive oneself with claims of ignorance. In some ways, providing capabilities to non-contractible subjects is more damaging than drug trafficking.

Boundarism's verdict for powerful private entities: **The closer your capabilities get to sovereignty, the closer your responsibilities get to constitutional level.**

3.2 Collusion

When private entities gain national-level capabilities, governments don't react with alarm—they breathe a sigh of relief. Governments inherently fear complexity, and private entities excel at turning complexity into black-box services: "Pay me, don't ask questions." The two naturally align: governments

get cheaper governance tools; companies get greater legitimacy and monopolistic barriers. This is the starting point of collusion.

Collusion isn't a conspiracy—it's **aligned incentives**. Governments pursue control, accountability, and scapegoats; companies pursue exclusivity, pricing power, and scalability. Their meeting doesn't produce better public services, but a new power structure: power outsourced to companies, responsibility outsourced to algorithms; legitimacy stays with governments, profits with companies.

What society gets is an untraceable chain of responsibility and no exit options.

Let's set aside communication and media—let's start with public health:

Alzheimer's disease (AD), a degenerative condition, encapsulates the structural absurdity of modern healthcare: hard to cure, terrifying, burdensome, massive market potential, and an evidence chain that can be engineered.

The harsh reality of AD is that degenerative changes accumulate over time; neurological damage can't be reversed to its original state. For patients, realistic expectations aren't cures—only delay, relief, and maintenance. But regulatory systems reward not long-term prevention or early intervention, but **approveable single-molecule treatment narratives**. Treatments can deliver endpoint metrics in short cycles; prevention requires decades of data, complex attribution, and cross-entity settlement.

Collusion emerged almost spontaneously.

The FDA has a rigorous new drug application process—so strict that small companies stand no chance. But if you can produce evidence that fits its rules, approval follows—and with approval, the payment and pricing chain kicks in automatically. Companies learned to optimize not the drug's biological performance, but the approval path—even welcoming higher approval thresholds and costs.

This means finding a molecule that passes FDA approval is a license to print money—tens of billions in annual profits, in perpetuity. The FDA and pharmaceutical giants are far more expert in biomedicine than I am, yet they deliberately ignore a truth: **brain degeneration is irreversible; AD is an inevitable byproduct of longer life expectancy.** For the public, AD means fear: memory loss, disability, loss of self. They seek authority, but the authority they imagine doesn't tell them: "This is normal. As biological beings, we all have an end—AD is just one probabilistic outcome."

Lack of education leads the public to outsource judgment: approved = safe; new drug = hope. This completes the moral grandstanding: approval is no longer a technical necessity, but emotional comfort. When the public stops thinking, the healthcare system gains a stable market: not paying for cures (which don't exist), but for hope.

The FDA and pharmaceutical giants hold the power to set prices, make rules, and monopolize information on life and health—capabilities approaching public health sovereignty. Yet they fail to fulfill their constitutional-level

responsibility to tell the public the core truth and defend healthcare's boundaries. Instead, they exploit information asymmetry and man-made rules to build a closed loop that exploits the public.

Boundarism offers solutions here:

1. **Classification:** Categorize diseases separately, with degenerative diseases in their own class. Humans are biological beings; finitude is our first nature—don't fight biology.
2. **Phased approval:** Lower thresholds drastically. Initial approvals are temporary, revocable, limited to short-term use, small populations, and narrow indications—adjust dynamically based on real-world data.
3. **Profit clawback:** If subsequent evidence shows benefits were systematically exaggerated, trigger punitive clawbacks.
4. **Incentives:** Institutionalize rewards for prevention and early intervention; allocate more research support to these areas than to so-called "treatments."

Boundarism never demands morality or kindness—these are personal and organizational choices. But **profiting by eroding others' boundaries is never permissible**. The AD example is just one typical case of cross-sector collusion. From the day AD was defined as a disease rather than a natural phenomenon, it became a game to chase tens of billions in annual profits. It's tedious. Boundarism prioritizes definition above all—get the definition wrong, and everything falls apart. Defining a normal biological process as a disease—was that really for the cure?

Boundarism's verdict here: **You are powerful. Please don't exploit human vulnerability.**

3.3 The Anti-Intellectual Money Machine

After the mobile internet, humanity gained unlimited information—while descending into unlimited anti-intellectualism. It sounds contradictory, but it's not mysterious: information hasn't made people smarter; it's turned everyone into precisely calculable traffic. TikTok is the machine that cracked the code of traffic, turning anti-intellectualism into a money printer, and amygdala training into a business model.

TikTok isn't media—it's **behavioral engineering**. When Zhang Yiming was interviewed while starting his business, he said he wanted to build a platform where "previously, people searched for information; in the future, information will find people." I've always thought there was an unspoken second half:

ByteDance decides which information finds whom.

Since the short video era, humans have been losing one of our most precious evolutionary traits—**delayed gratification**. Text → prefrontal cortex → No; Short videos → amygdala → Yes. Have we forgotten that the prefrontal cortex took tens of thousands of years to evolve? Writing evolved through hieroglyphs → phonograms → wars → systems → unification to become what it is today—but in the short video era, we seem to have discarded that.

Earlier, we discussed nations and the inevitability of civilization—at its core, it's about incentives. Yet today, humans aren't incentivized to be more rational; we're incentivized to be more anti-intellectual. Even shopping has shifted from reading images, reviews, and details to watching live streams. Every action steers us toward one goal: **removing the prefrontal cortex from the decision-making center.**

You don't need to read, work, or build—just have a stance, mock, and rage to get traffic, and traffic converts to money. Anti-intellectualism becomes an economic advantage: shorter, faster, harsher, more shameless content that stimulates the amygdala gets more traffic and makes more money. When a platform's business model is built on training human regression, it poses an **existential civilizational risk**. You can't expect it to reform voluntarily—anti-intellectualism is its profit source.

From a neurobiological perspective, short video platforms work just like addictive substances: they **hijack the dopamine reward circuit**. Take nicotine: it stimulates acetylcholine receptors, making the brain's reward system more likely to release dopamine, linking that release to a behavior—so you keep reaching for the next cigarette. You think you're chasing pleasure; you're actually chasing relief from craving.

Short videos operate the same way.

They use infinite scrolling, unpredictable rewards (the unknown of the next video), instant feedback (likes, comments, popularity), and emotional

stimulation (plot twists, humiliation, anger, novelty) to create a supercharged slot machine. Every swipe is a pull—you don't know the next outcome, it might be more satisfying, so you can't stop. This isn't entertainment; it's training—training you to treat attention as a commodity, and your brain as a mine.

I find it strange: nicotine faces global regulatory crackdowns for hijacking dopamine, but short videos get a free pass. Why? Don't we have enough knowledge to deconstruct this? Why not regulate software that achieves the same effect as nicotine?

From a Boundarism perspective, this happens because governments have failed to uphold their boundaries—they don't know what to do or what to avoid. They charge ahead in areas where political correctness and displays of power are obvious, even without a clear direction. I can hardly imagine them debating bills to ban nicotine products in parliament while scrolling short videos.

To be fair, human evolution hasn't been easy—not by a long shot. As animals, early humans learned to save food for winter, to plant seeds and wait months for a harvest. This cycle gave birth to agrarian civilization. Do you know how hard it is to give a rabbit a carrot and make it not eat it immediately?

Biological training in anti-intellectualism will lead to a terrifying outcome: a divide between humans who retain rational logic and those whose animal instincts are amplified—possibly a 1% to 99% split. If this split correlates with

wealth and social status, I'll make a prediction: **the next massacre awaits us, and platforms will be the trigger.**

I've written this book with restraint—except here. Sometimes I wonder why I'm doing this. I'm not particularly smart, no sense of mission or survival pressure drives me. I just think it has to be done. I've witnessed firsthand the social changes since the short video era: humans haven't become more rational; we've become angrier, more agitated. Popular content lacks depth. If you look at short video trends in recent years, creators of videos over 30 seconds now clip the climax and put it at the start—afraid of losing traffic. Commoditizing attention has tamed not just users, but creators: how many seconds until the conflict? How contrasting should the characters be?

Two-hour movies are cut into 10-minute recaps; 40-minute TV shows become 2-minute skits. The result: people struggle to focus on a full movie, let alone a book. Once, an IP character's popularity required comics, animations, novels—loving a character took time, shaped by events and conflicts. The rise of Pop-Mart proves that in this age of fragmented attention, you don't need to spend hundreds of episodes following *One Piece*—just find a character cute, add a blind box mechanism, and you create addiction.

Anti-intellectualism is a money printer, and some are celebrating the bonanza. But the cost of anti-intellectualism will be borne by society as a whole.

Boundarism's verdict here: **Everything has a price.**

3.4 The Absence of Reason - When Moral Grandstanding Takes Over Academia

Academic communities should be humanity's closest link to reason—a firewall defending the bottom line. When anti-intellectualism becomes a trend, the academic community, which should have curbed it, cowers in fear of being labeled "incorrect" in the moral grandstanding contest.

Moral grandstanding has turned academia away from truth, evidence, and logic—prioritizing stance over whether something hurts a narrative. Media platforms have fueled this, but they aren't the cause. The erosion of boundaries is the starting point of this decline.

In 2007, James Watson said in an interview: "I'm inherently gloomy about the prospect of Africa... because... their intelligence is the same as ours—whereas all the testing says not really." In 2019, when asked if his views had changed, he replied: "No, not at all."

The result: Cold Spring Harbor Laboratory quickly distanced itself, publicly calling his remarks "reprehensible" and "unsupported by science," revoking his honorary titles and cutting all ties. What started as controversial remarks escalated to institutional moral and scientific condemnation.

Compare this to the NBA's response to Daryl Morey. Facing billions in immediate losses and intense national pressure, Adam Silver stated publicly: "The league won't apologize for Morey's tweet, and supports employees'

freedom of speech and expression." The league paid a real price to defend its employees' right to speak—a line in the sand.

The academic and sports worlds delivered two starkly different answers to a core question: What exactly are organizations defending when they stand by an individual?

They're defending a boundary—one written in constitutions, not morality.

Let's see the consequences when this boundary is erased. Suppose I'm a researcher who discovers a gene sequence linked to Down syndrome, with higher prevalence in a specific ethnic group. I see how Cold Spring Harbor treated Watson, notice my lab leans politically correct, and quietly withdraw my paper. Instead, I decide to study how light intensity affects the sexual behavior frequency of lab rats. When this boundary crumbles, researchers learn not to get closer to the truth, but to avoid trouble, avoid being ostracized, write "safe" papers, and pass problems to the next generation.

We need to clarify where academia/universities' boundaries should lie. What exactly are universities protecting?

- Physical safety and procedural justice, of course.
- Protecting the vulnerable from violence and discrimination, too.

But when "protection" expands to **shielding certain views from questioning**, it oversteps.

Imagine saying this in a European academic institution: "It seems human activity has little impact on atmospheric change." Best case, you're dismissed;

lucky for you, they don't have SpaceX—otherwise, you'd be sent to Mars.

Note: You didn't even say "no impact"—just posed a hypothesis, asked a question.

In a healthy academic environment, this statement would trigger: "Let's examine this—data, models, counterarguments, repeated experiments." In a

morally grandstanding academic environment, it triggers a personal trial:

"Who's paying you? Oil companies? Are you endangering humanity's future?"

Discussion ends before it begins; the question shifts from true/false to good/evil.

You quickly realize the risk isn't failure—it's offense. So you self-censor, use vague language, change research directions, and learn to write compliant papers with inoffensive conclusions. Do this well, and you get published, secure funding, and get promoted. You leave behind a pile of abstract, meaningless work—but civilization loses its rarest asset: **the courage to ask unpopular questions.**

This is what I mean: public anti-intellectualism is bad enough, but **silenced intellectuals are a disaster.** When academia bans certain hypotheses, it stops being academia and becomes theology—trying to overthrow God, only to set up things more sacred than God. And these things are strange—for example, the claim that there are more than 8 genders.

I know academia faces pressures: political forces want to co-opt it, businesses want to bribe it, the public wants to consume it, and careerists want to use it

for credibility. But have you forgotten? Your predecessors advanced science and technology in far harsher conditions—without your 300-square-meter houses or 3.0-liter SUVs. They had only one thing you've lost: **a hunger for truth.**

Boundarism's verdict here: **Why bow?**

3.5 To My Dear Politicians

By now, you've seen it.

Of course you have—you read polls, trending words, platform data, emotion curves every day. You know society is fracturing, reason is fading, public discourse is increasingly like tribal warfare. Yet you keep doubling down, because moral grandstanding has begun—you have to prove you're more correct, more moral than the other side in the shortest time.

You've turned politics into a competition, governance into posturing, complexity into an enemy. You replace argument with humiliation, evidence with stance, responsibility with political correctness. And so society becomes what it is today: anti-intellectualism as a business advantage, extremism as an algorithmic high-reward rule, emotion as fuel.

You must see yourselves as victims—blaming platforms, the public, the times.

No. This is first and foremost **a failure of politics.**

Because you set the rules: what to reward, what to punish; what's the bottom line of public discourse, what emotions can be exploited. You used the

cheapest weapons—fear and hatred—as governance tools, then expressed surprise when society became ungovernable.

Fiscal deficits are just numbers; the foundation of civilizational credit has also been eroded. You've overdrawn not just monetary debt, but the foundation of trust, cooperation, and delayed gratification. When a society loses the ability to delay gratification, it loses the rule of law, education, science, and long-term investment. You trained society to be instant-gratification addicts, then expected it to bear decades of debt and institutional costs—what absurd logic.

Your terms last only a few years, but policy consequences can linger for decades. You trade short-term political gains for long-term social costs; future generations pay the interest, the next administration bears the collapse, history bears the blame. You pretend your descendants don't live on this planet, as if the world has nothing to do with you after you leave office.

The most typical example: they sit in their chairs, speaking slowly: "We all know Iran doesn't have the capability to develop nuclear weapons, so the necessity of this war..."

Exactly. The fact that they can speak so casually proves Iran has no nuclear capability—otherwise, they'd be in a conference room discussing how to pay \$5 billion to Iran to stop it from dropping a nuclear bomb on Dubai. I truly wonder if they understand the Taqiyya principle or the doctrines of the Islamic Republic of Iran. What exactly did they want to express in that TV interview?

Did they even know? I'm certain he's not a bad person—but I'm equally certain he had no idea what he was saying.

This is the crux of the problem: we never had a mechanism to hold accountable the "good people" who don't know what they're doing—after the fact. Accountability isn't the goal; it's a means. Only the courtroom can force these "good people" to think about what they're doing and whether they're willing to bear the consequences.

Boundarism offers three suggestions here:

1. **Stop using morality as a weapon.** Morality has no place in elections—it's for personal restraint.
2. **Remember what everyone said and promised.** Establish a traceability mechanism. Even decades later, hold their feet to the fire—make them face their past words and actions. This is the only way to mature. Humans are products of training; political training that doesn't require long-term accountability only normalizes short-sightedness—and this should never be allowed.
3. **Unified standards**—we must introduce a universal evaluation scale based on human nature: hire more biologists and social psychologists to systematically assess how each policy, each mechanism, affects human physiology and psychology. Humans don't survive by just controlling the body. If humans only needed to eat to live, no one would commit suicide.

Scholars have written extensively on how power reshapes the human nervous system. I've long been curious—why do people become what they once hated most? I'll explore the physiological and psychological analysis of politicians and imperial interpreters in a later chapter. For now, I'll offer a counterintuitive core judgment: **watch if politicians start explaining themselves endlessly.**

Humans eat when hungry, drink when thirsty—these actions require no explanation; they happen naturally. So when an action requires piles of justifications and defenses, it's likely wrong—at least half-wrong. Even a war, if it needs countless explanations to justify, probably shouldn't have happened. The same goes for healthcare policies, tax policies, and public decisions.

Psychology has long told us: when you deeply believe something is right, you don't feel the need to defend it to the world. Explanation is never a sign of strength—it's a sign you're seeking external validation to fill the gap in your own sense of legitimacy.

Boundarism's verdict for this chapter: **It's not hard. The hard part is stopping self-deception and starting to think.**

3.6 Tools Usurping the Master

Humans created writing to transmit information more accurately; culture to collaborate more stably; nations to organize resources efficiently and protect individuals. These are all human tools—and a tool's only value is **whether it serves humans as an end.**

But the most common and deadly form of civilizational regression is **tools usurping the master**. Imagine a tribe tens of thousands of years ago with an ax—then all tribe members sacrificing themselves to defend that ax. It seems unrealistic, but today it's normal.

Here's my view: finite individuals create tools that transcend finitude, then bind themselves to these tools to try to overcome their own limits. AI will be an exception—whether it transcends finitude is a choice, which we'll discuss in *The AI Constitution*.

Let's examine how many boundaries have been breached to let tools override the purpose of "serving humans."

First boundary: The biological boundary of finitude. The prefrontal cortex is a double-edged sword—it gave us rational thinking and delayed gratification, but also forces us to ask about meaning. Humans have an innate anxiety about meaningless existence—more damaging than physical threats like hunger or cold.

Second boundary: Super-individuality from social cooperation. Large-scale cooperation inherently requires tools to be super-individual—culture, currency, ideas, rules. This way, tools don't fail when an individual dies or changes their mind. Once super-individuality emerges, tools gain an inherent drive for self-preservation. Take the UN: even when its rules fail, it tolerates violations, and only restrains the strong—it still clings to stability. Why? Because without the system, everyone inside loses their purpose.

Third boundary: Cognitive boundaries. Academia's quantitative evaluation system: originally a tool to assess academic output, based on paper count, impact factor, and citations. Over time, cognitive boundaries erode—goals shift automatically to "publish in top journals, secure grants, get promotions"—this is what a "good scholar" should do. The original purpose of academia—exploring truth—no longer matters. When metrics replace truth, tools complete their usurpation.

Fourth boundary: Institutional roots. Humans are naturally risk-averse and afraid of taking responsibility for choices. Tools are the perfect scapegoats. To avoid responsibility, humans can surrender all rights to tools, then deify them as unquestionable authorities. Like the politician I mentioned earlier—he doesn't need to take responsibility for his words; he can say: "This is my democratic right, this is what voters demand." The more authoritative the tool, the less questionable it is—the greater the space for human exemption. Like a snowball, tools become more sacred, responsibility thinner.

Here's the corresponding framework:

1. **Meaning must center on humans**—humans are ends, never merely means (Kant, 1785).
2. **Tools must be controlled by humans.** Being a servant to ideas, a slave to currency, or fuel for culture is a personal choice. If Nietzsche could declare God is dead over a century ago, we can declare tools are dead today. After all,

the Bible says God created humans—but tools are clearly human creations.

Why voluntarily submit to their rules?

3. **Humans must have a meta-boundary.** Humans shouldn't control the definition of "humanity"; similarly, individuals shouldn't let others define their value. Working in a system, using a platform—this doesn't mean you have to brainwash yourself to fit their needs.
4. **Humans must take responsibility for their choices.** We need to repair the broken chain of responsibility. When public figures take responsibility for their actions, it sets an example for society.

Boundarism's verdict: **Tools must serve humans.**

3.7 Drawing Lines in the Sand

After tools usurp the master, cages emerge. Humans draw these lines themselves, treating them as sacred, uncrossable barriers—then live for them, hate for them, kill for them. Throughout history, this line has had many names: history, culture, nation, religion, country. They were all supposed to be tools to expand cooperation radius—but once deified, they start shrinking it instead—dividing the world into us and them.

Civilizational regression rarely starts with violence—it starts with language.

When words like glory, humiliation, justice, and blood debt become unquestionable, humans no longer need reason—only stance.

History can be remembered, but not endlessly avenged. Otherwise, you get a world that's logically perfect but practically insane—everyone, every nation, every culture is perpetually in debt, and hatred exists between all groups. Over 20,000 years ago, the ancestors of the Inuit passed through the Yellow River basin on their way to the Bering Strait—and stole a chicken from my ancestor. There were no cameras or witnesses, but if I traveled to Alaska and asked: "Hey, where's my chicken?" How absurd would that be?

The example is extreme, but many grand narratives do the same: using an unfalsifiable past as an eternal indulgence, justifying all present actions as revenge. This isn't justice—it's a perpetual motion machine. Its fuel is humanity's cheapest pleasure: outsourcing responsibility to history, turning aggression into reckoning.

Boundarism must draw a line in the sand when it comes to history:

Civilization must have a statute of limitations. For cooperation to expand, the future takes priority over the present, and the present over the past.

I never assume the worst of people who draw lines in the sand—but their actions predict consequences:

- The Manchu conquest of the Han was humiliation.
- Han "invasion" of Korea was glory.

The same act, different directions—two narratives. This means they don't want eternal indulgence for history; they want **one-way settlement rights**: forever

claiming compensation from others, never paying it; forever mobilizing hatred, never bearing consequences.

Under this narrative, cooperation loses its foundation—because cooperation depends on consistent rules, not selective morality. From a Boundarism perspective, this poses enormous contractual risk: they no longer uphold the principle of human equality—a critical red flag.

I think people from different countries, regions, and ethnicities should reach a consensus: **Do we want to develop, to expand cooperation radius?** If not, that's fine—develop separately. If yes, draw a line under the past: no more digging up grievances beyond a certain point. Trying to have it both ways—enjoying the benefits of expanded cooperation and productivity while retaining the right to settle historical scores—is exhausting. It's like partnering with someone who holds a knife to your waist: you can only work with one hand, and you have to keep your waist stiff. Why bother?

For years, this "have it both ways" logic persisted because credit currency was invented late, and the UN and WTO blindly embraced the principle of national equality. Many countries exploited the system's loopholes. If boundaries had been clear from the start—how far back to settle old scores, whether to cooperate in the future—then education and cultural narratives in every country would have aligned with this principle. The world would be much quieter.

Boundarism's verdict here: **The past or the future—make it clear.**

Chapter 4: Human Interfaces

4.1 Language Systems, Trade and Religion

Human writing began with pictographs—all civilizations started with pictographs, as humans needed to record what they saw with their own eyes.

Let's trace the evolution of writing: starting with Sumerian cuneiform and Egyptian hieroglyphs, Semitic-speaking peoples in Egyptian-controlled and influenced regions needed a simpler, more practical writing system for daily use.

So they adopted some phonetic symbols from hieroglyphs, using the initial sound of the object's name to represent sounds—giving birth to the earliest consonantal alphabet, abjad. The number of symbols plummeted, and learning costs dropped drastically.

Then came the Phoenicians. They used this alphabet for bookkeeping, contracts, and labeling goods during Mediterranean trade—productivity doubled overnight.

The Greeks adopted it, finding it highly useful. To better suit their language, they converted some symbols into vowels, making it more compatible with Indo-European languages.

When the Roman Empire rose, the Latin alphabet inherited and spread this system. Coupled with the invention of printing, it eventually formed the dominant phonetic system used worldwide today.

Why does this matter? Because **communicative power comes from compressibility + adaptability + replicability.**

Trade scenarios require writing that's repetitive, high-frequency, short-form, and verifiable—think quantities, prices, weights, names, places. This gave phonetic writing (linear phonemic alphabets) a huge advantage over logographic writing. With just a few dozen symbols, you could spell almost any word—especially names and places that couldn't be drawn. The radius of cooperation thus broke free from imperial boundaries.

In imperial times, logographic writing served a dual purpose: governance and ritual. It enshrined power as sacred. Those who mastered this language system became imperial interpreters—the priestly class bridging gods and humans.

Here's the fascinating part: ancient Greece gave birth to civic politics, public debate, and written law—thanks to the Greek language. Language became an objectified tool; the alphabet freed writing from the hands of a small group of scribes. Language no longer depended on a central authority, but on countless contracts and texts. The Roman Empire could fall, but Latin endured; the Alexandrian Empire could collapse, but Greek remained in use.

Alongside linear phonemic writing systems came the spread of monotheism: trade requires contracts, and contracts need to solve a fundamental problem—**are you contracting with a human or an animal?** At the time, no secular power could provide a cross-civilizational, universal definition of human equality—only monotheism could do that. By invoking a transcendent

god, it granted equal status to people across regions, ethnicities, and languages—solving the core question of who was eligible to enter into contracts. Thus, linear phonemic writing systems, combined with monotheism, laid the foundation for global trade.

As a human-created tool, religion has played a decisive role in civilization—and that role is rooted in transcendence. In other words, no matter how humanity develops, we cannot discuss technology, civilization, or trade without acknowledging transcendence (all secular power). This isn't a theological question; it's an **engineering question of cooperation**: contracts between strangers need a common foundation that transcends tribes.

Over thousands of years, the tools created by humans and the progress of civilization have evolved in mutual interaction. Religion expanded the radius of cooperation and boosted productivity; the release of productivity, in turn, reformed religion, which then unleashed productivity once more. Language systems are so critical to humanity that we can say: **it's almost impossible for civic politics to emerge spontaneously within a logographic writing system**. Understand this, and you'll understand why South Korea, Japan, and Vietnam abandoned Chinese characters—their first step toward modernity was breaking free from imperial boundaries.

This is what Wittgenstein meant when he said: **"The limits of my language mean the limits of my world."**

4.2 What Is Law?

In imperial legal systems, law was once elevated to a quasi-sacred status.

Expressed through language, it formed the framework for social governance.

Breaking the law seemed like a heinous act.

From a Boundarism perspective, law, as a social contract, follows a structure of

"comply → no punishment; violate → punishment." Law is not morality, not

faith, and certainly not a tool for rulers. Its only legitimate source is

authorization: the governed authorize the government to formulate

predictable rules to reduce violence and uncertainty. In other words, the

functional role of law is a **cooperation interface that reduces friction,**

lowers transaction costs, and increases trust. If it fails to reduce costs and

instead creates fear, ambiguity, and unlimited interpretive power, it ceases to

be law—and becomes a theological edict.

The reconstruction of law under Boundarism starts with three principles:

1. **Law must be clearly defined—ban "sacred word legislation"**

Any vague word entering law becomes a space for power manipulation. Law

must prohibit sacred words—security, stability, correctness, order, morality,

civilization, and especially "other." Without clear boundaries, evidence

thresholds, and auditable standards, these words must be deemed illegal

clauses. A special note on "other": while words like "security" and "morality"

expand interpretive space by accident, "other" actively demands it.

2. **Law must protect the right to opt out**

This is critical. Law itself embodies the collective contract of society, but for any law, there will always be dissenters. It's unjust to force someone to be bound by a legal system they reject—they should be free to leave, and law must guarantee that freedom. Exercising the right to opt out also involves settling past obligations—it is not an escape from responsibility.

3. **The principle of maximizing choice**

Modern law loves to deprive people of certain rights in the name of their "health," "safety," or "life." Boundarism holds that since humans are "a set of possibilities within finite boundaries," protecting choice means protecting possibility itself—**provided it does not violate others' boundaries**. Given this definition, choosing to abandon all basic rights and become a slave violates the very essence of being human; voluntarily surrendering choice is also a denial of choice.

We take these three principles as the cornerstone of legal reconstruction under Boundarism because they form an unbreakable logical loop. They fundamentally solve the problems of law's legitimacy, boundaries, and purpose, freeing it from the inherent traps of power and interest expansion in traditional legal systems.

The first principle addresses what law governs. The second solves the voluntary nature of contracts—without the right to opt out, a contract is essentially coercion and abduction. The third defines law's ultimate purpose: law does not exist to shape "better humans," because no one can know what

constitutes a "better human" in any era. This is a basic humility in the face of human finitude. These three principles—from the boundaries of the rules themselves, to the bottom-line rights of individuals, to law's ultimate purpose—are interdependent. Without clear definitions, the right to opt out and the right to choose become empty promises; without the right to opt out, even the clearest rules can be monopolized by power to form coercion; without the principle of maximizing choice, law will eventually deviate from its mission and gradually become a tool of control.

Boundarism requires the right to opt out to have three interfaces—**movable, settleable, and bearable**. Mobility prevents law from degenerating into a servitude; settlement ensures the right to liquidate obligations and rights; bearability sets a ceiling on the cost of opting out.

Looking at the progress of human law over centuries, we see law governing more and more aspects of life—yet no one ever asks: **what is the purpose of governing so much?** A legal system divorced from its ultimate purpose will eventually revert to the Middle Ages, regulating even sexual positions. The only legitimate reason for individuals to surrender rights is to better protect everyone's basic boundaries—and that surrender must be voluntary, with the right to opt out, and clearly bounded (e.g., taxation, public health policies). It is never permissible to infinitely infringe on individuals' core choices in the name of abstract concepts like "the overall interests of society."

Based on a Boundarism view of law, we must completely restructure our understanding of breaking the law. In traditional legal systems, breaking the law is defined as violating state rules and challenging ruling order—so its core logic is punishment: the state punishes the offender, convicting them in the name of the state. But from a Boundarism perspective, this is entirely wrong. The essence of breaking the law is never challenging the ruler's authority—it is an individual breaching the agreed boundaries with other members of society and infringing on their legitimate rights. Law exists to protect every individual's boundaries from violation. Given this essence, the handling of violations should follow this logic:

1. **Highest priority—repair the breached boundary.** The first thing an offender must do is restore the violated boundary to its original state. This is the core of addressing violations, as law's primary mission is to protect boundaries—not vent anger.
2. **Secondary priority—compensate for losses if the boundary cannot be fully restored.** For example, the recovery costs, litigation costs, and emotional damages caused by fraud. The offender not only breached the victim's boundary but also forced them to bear unnecessary costs—these costs must be covered by the offender.
3. **Last priority—punishment.** After attempting to repair the boundary and compensate for losses, law may impose additional punishment on the offender. The purpose of this punishment is primarily to increase the future

cost of default for the offender, while giving other members of society a clear expectation: the cost of breaching others' boundaries far outweighs the benefits.

We must clearly recognize that law's ultimate purpose is not to create a perfect society without crime, risk, or error. On the contrary, a society that tries to eliminate all risk and error through law is inevitably a totalitarian society with no boundaries or freedom. Because eliminating all risk requires constantly depriving choice; once choice is completely lost and there is no right to opt out, law will eventually transform from a protector of freedom's boundaries into a cage that imprisons it.

Boundarism's verdict on law: **Do not let imperial-era legal thinking become a shackle for humanity's future.**

4.3 The Brutality of Boundarism

Boundarism is not one of those philosophies that paint a beautiful vision and then persuade people to half-heartedly abandon their rights and subjectivity. I won't say "follow me, and we'll pursue a fair, beautiful world where everyone is happy." For me, I have no idea what constitutes beauty or happiness. Once someone claims to have that definition, their next step will be to seek the power to reshape humans—and that is precisely what Boundarism seeks to prevent.

Boundarism is brutal because it **refuses to lie**:

It acknowledges human finitude, that the world is full of risk, that mistakes cannot be eliminated, that death is non-negotiable.

The result of Boundarism is like that first cell—once it had a membrane, deciding what could enter and what could exit became its own business. There is no romance of merging into one; only the reality of drawing boundaries. Unclear boundaries mean death for the cell; clear boundaries mean life can reproduce, evolve, and cooperate.

Human society is no different.

No boundaries, no subjects; no subjects, no responsibility; no responsibility, no credit; no credit, no cooperation. All the allure of grand narratives lies in inducing you to surrender your boundaries: hand yourself over to the state, the organization, morality—in exchange for that eternal indulgence from history. The moment you surrender, you feel a brief sense of relief—because you no longer have to take responsibility. But what you gain is not freedom, but being used.

The brutality of Boundarism first manifests in three prohibitions:

1. **No dehumanization.** No religion, state, or law—no human creation—may touch the right to define "human." Love your enemy; your enemy is also human—this is not kindness, but the bottom line of civilization.
2. **No outsourcing of outcomes.** All choices have consequences, and those who make the choices must bear them. If choices and outcomes are mismatched, society will be monopolized by opportunists.

3. **No open-ended claims.**

History can be remembered, but hatred cannot be inherited. Suffering can be commemorated, but revenge cannot be endless. Justice without a statute of limitations is nothing but a permanent license for violence. We prohibit infinite revenge and hatred, but we do not deny intergenerational harm—compensation and redress within reasonable limits are acceptable.

Boundarism is thus not romantic; it is more like a **cold contract**:

Freedom has its price.

Dignity has its loneliness.

The future requires abandoning the past as a weapon.

This is the brutality of Boundarism. If humanity is to leave this planet, like our ancestors who walked into the forest with spears tens of thousands of years ago, we must return to maturity.

Boundarism says: **Make your choice, and bear the consequences.**

Some people cannot be saved—not because they are stupid, but because they voluntarily choose to be fuel. They do not want freedom; they want certainty.

They do not want responsibility; they want exemption. They do not want truth; they want resonance. For such people, joining a grand narrative is not being deceived—it is a transaction: exchanging subjectivity for a sense of meaning, abandoning thinking for a sense of security.

The life of fuel is certainly absurd. A shift in the grand narrative means they must be ready to change their stance at any time. This is perfectly acceptable.

Boundarism's attitude toward this is clear: **Civilization is inherently inclusive of uncivilization, because humanity cannot be uniform.** But inclusion has a premise: uncivilization must not hinder the progress of civilization. Not because civilization is more noble or superior, but because once the radius of cooperation is affected, everyone will retreat to the forest together.

Boundarism does not seek to reform fuel; it only does one thing—**risk isolation.** Fuel can burn, but it cannot ignite the city. Tribes can exist, but they cannot destroy contracts. Dehumanization can be expressed, but it cannot gain access to civilization's infrastructure and mobilization capabilities.

This is not a moral judgment; it is merely self-preservation. You cannot eliminate absurdity, but you should at least prevent it from spreading into institutions: **It can burn, but it can not spread.**

4.4 The Prefrontal Cortex: A Double-Edged Sword

When humans truly mature, they face a realization:

We must confront the fact that our existence is absolutely dispensable to the world.

This is the double-edged sword of the prefrontal cortex.

I have often been troubled by a question: Did the empire come first, or did the imperial interpreters come first to create the empire? I finally understood a premise: in a foraging society, there could be no such thing as imperial

interpreters. From a productivity perspective, without surplus goods, there is no distribution problem; without distribution problems, there is no need for explanation or justification—and thus no need for interpreters.

The empire and its interpreters are thus products of progress—specifically, products of the prefrontal cortex. The prefrontal cortex gave humans the ability to delay gratification—to save grain for the winter, to plant seeds for the next year. It gave humans the ability to abstract and model—to create abstract concepts around which people could cooperate: states, laws, religions, trade.

These things drove productivity growth, and with it came surplus and distribution. People began to ask: **Who deserves what?** At this point, the functions created by the prefrontal cortex found a new use—**justifying distribution, legitimizing power**. Explanation became a necessity, and the class of interpreters inevitably emerged. Their job was to translate inequality into order, plunder into justice, fear into security, sacrifice into virtue. Using the prefrontal cortex, they crafted a set of "stories" to make people accept what others wanted them to accept. For the first time, humans entered a strange state: reality remained the same, but the narrative changed—and with the narrative, the world changed.

This is the double-edged sword of the prefrontal cortex. Its existence drives humans to seek meaning.

It allows humans to build empires, but also to kneel before them: Who am I?

Why do I live? Why do I submit? Explaining and confronting these questions is painful. As the body's most energy-intensive organ, the brain's instinct is to avoid overexertion. For most of human history, we lived in energy scarcity—so the optimal solution, when imperial interpreters said "do not be confused; I have all the answers," was for most people to follow, reducing unnecessary energy expenditure.

This is why the pre-Qin strategies of fooling and weakening the people were surprisingly advanced. Without biology or neuroscience, they discovered that by reducing individuals' energy supply, they could better integrate them into the imperial narrative. Today, humanity no longer lacks energy—so another nail has been hammered into the empire's coffin.

I will not advocate for some kind of subjectivity narrative, urging people to confront the question of existence's meaning. My answer is never optimistic. A society where everyone confronts this question would face even greater problems—an epidemic of nihilism. The only advice I can offer is threefold:

1. **Leave ambiguity to transcendence; leave specificity to humans.** Do not outsource ultimate meaning to human creations; do not hand over specific responsibilities to abstract narratives.
2. **Leave word meanings to definitions; leave narratives to evidence.** A mature human society has no need for interpreters.

3. **Freedom comes with a price; dignity is based on responsibility.** Regardless

of how time passes, empires will grow farther from humanity—and their existence no longer holds positive value for civilization's progress.

In practice, when you cannot explain or solve something, hand it over to transcendence. This transcendence can be God, fate, the will of the universe, or karma—whatever it is, let it go. Find value and meaning within your own capabilities. You cannot hand over the right to interpret meaning to the state, organizations, or morality—because these things are essentially products serving specific distribution orders. Once you surrender that right, you hand over your boundaries to the interpreters—and in doing so, you create more interpreters. You can believe in God, but you cannot believe in those who claim to be God's messengers. You can awe the will of the universe, but you cannot awe those who claim to grasp the laws of the universe. The value of transcendence here is that it cannot be monopolized by human power; it will never endorse specific distribution orders. It is your last line of defense for preserving your own boundaries.

Although the empire's coffin is nailed shut, civilization progresses in spirals. If we do not address the problem of the prefrontal cortex, this spiral will still cause unnecessary disasters. The empire may be dead, but its ghost can be resurrected in the moral grandstanding of democracy. Everything described earlier essentially exploits this weakness—using the anxiety of the prefrontal cortex to create the certainty of the amygdala.

Boundarism must thus emphasize this cold principle once more: **Ambiguity can exist, but it must be isolated**. Ultimate meaning, ultimate justice, ultimate judgment—these ambiguities cannot be entrusted to humans or their creations. To those troubled by existential anxiety, Boundarism has only one message: **Do not let your anxiety become their fuel**.

4.5 Where We Came From, Where We' re Going

Looking at human developmental history, we find a strange phenomenon: our core physiological and neural structures still date back to the Pleistocene epoch tens of thousands of years ago. Yes, the human body and instincts are still adapted to the living environment of tens of thousands of years ago. Even relatively simple endocrine structures have failed to keep up with the drastic changes in our environment.

Take a simple example: diabetes. Three hundred years ago, aside from those with physiological disorders, it was unthinkable for humans to suffer from pancreatic failure due to excessive sugar intake. Our bodies never anticipated a day when there would be more sugar than we could metabolize. How did this day come? Certainly not at the hands of empires—it came from the continuous expansion of cooperation radius and the development of productivity.

This is just the smallest entry point. From the physiological collapse of individuals to the social disasters of groups, all stem from this rift: **we have**

rewritten the entire living environment by expanding the radius of cooperation, but the base pairs etched into our DNA have completely failed to keep up with this upheaval.

Our bodies are still prepared for scarcity: we crave sugar and fat, impulsively chase short-term rewards, automatically align with tribal symbols, and instinctively submit to fear.

Our brains are still prepared for the forest and grasslands: they excel at handling relationships among a dozen people, not at building abstract systems. They excel at dealing with immediate dangers, not at understanding long-term debt and probability. They excel at simplifying the world into us versus them, not at maintaining boundaries and contracts in a society of strangers.

Where we came from is thus not a romantic question—it is a mirror held up to ourselves. We come from a biological structure of tens of thousands of years ago, from scarcity, fear, tribal gatherings, and physiological feedback. Where we are going is not an Eden—it is an engineering problem: in an era of surplus productivity, information overload, and AI's birth, how can humans maintain their subjectivity? Can we continue to expand the radius of cooperation? What happens to those who stay in the past? Just as our bodies cannot adapt to excess sugar, our brains are instinctively unable to adapt to the power and information overload brought by AI.

Boundarism's answer to this question is written earlier and repeated here:

We cannot defeat hormones through moral grandstanding.

We cannot defeat the amygdala through grand narratives.

We cannot defeat biology through slogans of justice.

The premise of solving a problem is facing it. Our only viable path—

acknowledge boundaries, confront human finitude, and then lock it

within bearable limits through institutions and tools:

Maximize choice; ensure outcomes cannot be outsourced.

Expand the radius of cooperation; ensure the right to opt out is real.

Make tools more powerful while keeping them auditable and accountable.

Allow ambiguity to exist, but isolate it. Do not let any non-transcendent force touch the definition of "human"—whether it is individual authority, grand narratives, or human-made tools including AI.

This is the realistic version of where we are going. It is neither heaven nor hell, but a more mature society—one that acknowledges risk, failure, imperfection, and death, while rejecting dehumanization, sacredization, and unlimited interpretive power. We do not need a perfect society; we need a **correctable world**.

When humans begin to write these rules into institutions, using these boundaries as anchors for interfaces, we start to return to what it means to be human. And in the AI era, this becomes operable for the first time. AI can handle deduction, but humans must sign off. AI can increase rational density, but humans, based on a collectively agreed definition, decide whether AI is

human or not. Otherwise, we will witness a new species—giant infants with destructive power.

Chapter 5: The Future – Rewriting Institutions in the AI era

5.1 Platform Accountability

I wonder if today's giant platform companies realize they bear some responsibility for humanity's overall cognitive and rational levels—or if they only see themselves as profit-driven entities operating within commercial law and policy. Never before in human history has there been a media platform with access to billions of people—not even radio during World War II. Radio, television, and newspapers were one-way broadcasts; platforms are two-way interactions.

Putting Boundarism aside, let's speak plainly: a platform connecting hundreds of millions, even billions, of people claims no responsibility for humanity's rationality? Does that sound reasonable?

Of course not. Because platforms are never just ordinary businesses—they are **digital public interfaces**, the infrastructure of social operation, the "underlying operating system" of the real world. When a system connects billions of people's attention, public discourse, and information distribution networks, its actions are no longer mere corporate operations—they have irreversible public consequences. Platforms can claim to be apolitical, but they

cannot deny a core fact: they are redistributing human attention—and attention (human time) is the new tax base of this era.

Boundarism first offers a core definition here—**platform sovereignty**. When a company holds absolute power to decide who can speak, who can see, and how many can see, it wields quasi-sovereign power. Following our earlier core principle—**the closer capabilities get to sovereignty, the closer responsibilities get to constitutional level**.

A solemn statement: Boundarism is not inviting public power to re-infiltrate businesses or participate in content moderation and value shaping—public power has already created enough division, conflict, chaos, and disorder for human society. Boundarism's core claim here is that quasi-sovereign platform companies must establish clear, stable, consistent value systems and rule bottom lines—using these rules to guide human society toward greater rationality and respect for individual boundaries.

I sincerely state this: this is not a call for stricter regulation. For one thing, it is unnecessary; for another, companies should first clarify their own rights and responsibilities. Law has already granted these companies legitimate autonomy—I merely suggest they face up to the quasi-sovereign power in their hands and exercise this autonomy more responsibly.

Here, we propose the first unshakable requirement for companies with platform sovereignty—formulate their own open, transparent "platform constitution." Let me ask a simple question: if someone says, "All separatist

forces are enemies; enemies deserve to die; enemies are not human," should this user be allowed to connect to the world through the platform? Or another way: a user says, "Those who do not restore the Zhou Rites are barbarians; barbarians are unfit to be human." Do such users deserve access to intelligent products built on the system of equal contracts?

This is the crux: **can platforms allow them to use their systems, tokens, agents, payment, distribution, and mobilization capabilities?** If the answer is yes, then the platform is not neutral—it is providing infrastructure for dehumanization. This is not a free speech issue; it is a prerequisite for free speech. Only humans have freedom of speech—if someone is not considered human, where is the freedom to speak? Once the interface of infrastructure is provided, it is only a matter of scale and time.

If the answer is no, then the platform must acknowledge one thing: it is not value-neutral. It must have a meta-bottom line—a line on what it means to be human, what equality is, what is inviolable. This bottom line is not a political stance, but a civilizational foundation. Because the first step of platform sovereignty is never content moderation—it is deciding who can participate in cooperation.

Thus, the first article of the platform constitution should be: **Platforms shall not support dehumanization.** This is not just a user agreement clicked when opening the platform (which no one reads). Instead, when users enable commenting, they should manually input: "Enemies are also human;" or "I will

never deprive others of their right to be human." This would solve many problems. Anyone who excludes others from the definition of "human" should not gain access to the platform's infrastructure capabilities. This is not punishment—it is isolation. Parasites can exist, but they must be isolated; viruses can exist, but we should minimize their entry into the bloodstream. You will find that all debates between liberalism and collectivism converge here: **do you recognize the other as human?** If yes, everything can be discussed, contracts can be established, conflicts can be settled. If no, only slaughter remains—a matter of time.

Never underestimate the power of this simple input mechanism. It is like planting a seed in someone's mind. If the soil is too hard, the seed will not take root, and they will leave. For those where it takes root, the seed will eventually germinate. Even if their account is eventually banned per platform rules, they will fully understand—they violated the promise they made with their own hands. This is how the spirit of equality and contract is integrated into daily behavior.

Second article of the platform constitution: **Algorithms must be subject to traceable independent audits.** Platforms often package algorithms as untouchable black boxes, treating them as core trade secrets. But this logic has an unbreakable boundary: when a trade secret has irreversible public consequences for real society, it no longer qualifies for trade secret protection—it becomes an object that must be publicly audited. Let's break

down a realistic logic: a platform uses algorithms to deepen and amplify hatred and division between countries or groups. Diplomatic relations deteriorate, trade declines, civil strife intensifies—the platform earns all the traffic and profits, but the cost is borne by all citizens, even countless ordinary people in both countries. Is this fair? Thus, algorithms must be made public and fully audited, including core content: What is the objective function of content dissemination? How are addictive mechanisms designed? How is content moderated and classified? What are the content tags and user tags? Do algorithms amplify the amygdala (fear, opposition, conflict) or the prefrontal cortex (thinking, empathy, rationality)? How do algorithms classify and rank users?

Third article of the platform constitution: **Content scoring**. Here, we propose three target dimensions:

1. Content authenticity (1-5 stars)
2. Emotional incitement (1-5 stars)
3. Logical completeness (1-5 stars)

These ratings can be standardized by AI without affecting user autonomy or involving content restriction or removal. When content is posted, users can clearly see: what they are viewing is low-authenticity, stance-driven content with serious logical flaws and high emotional incitement. Users certainly have the right to view such content—but the platform must let them clearly know what they are consuming.

Boundary clauses: 1. Audits must be conducted by independent third-party institutions, including sociologists, biologists, legal experts, and ordinary user representatives. Platforms shall not interfere with the audit process or results, and audit reports must be made public. 2. AI rating models must also be publicly audited. Platforms shall not use rating weights to manipulate traffic distribution. Ratings are solely for user 知情权 and shall not be used as a basis for content restriction or removal—firmly upholding the bottom line of not interfering with user choice.

Boundarism borrows a line from Uncle Ben in *Spider-Man*—**with great power comes great responsibility**. Remember that.

5.2 Taxation in the AI era

In the internet era, companies already followed the 80/20 rule: the top player takes 80%, others split the remaining 20%. In the AI era, concentration will intensify—both in market share and social wealth. This raises a problem: tax systems designed for the industrial age are largely incompatible with this new era.

Writing this book has truly exhausted me. Humanity is not just biologically unable to keep up with the times—our institutions are far behind technological progress. We add patch after patch through endless bills and amendments, resulting in more and more complex laws, while core issues remain unresolved. Not only public health, academia, and education are

flawed—taxation and judiciary are too. I am certain this fatigue plagues every person in power.

Thus, we must dissect: **what exactly are we taxing?** To answer this, we first need to clarify what public services the government provides—and who benefits from them.

In the agricultural era, we taxed land—because land was the bottleneck of production.

In the industrial era, we taxed labor and corporate profits—because the organization of factories, capital, and labor was the bottleneck.

In the internet era, taxation began to lag—because value creation increasingly relied on network effects, software replication, and cross-border arbitrage.

Profits could drift on paper, while labor remained rooted in place.

In the AI era, the bottleneck will shift again. If we insist on taxing the AI era with industrial-era tax systems, we will face a consequence—**no taxes left to collect.**

We must break this down: what does the government provide? Healthcare, education, public safety—services for all citizens. Protection of property, while also for all, comes at vastly different costs for safeguarding \$100 billion versus \$10,000.

Beyond services, we must look at bottlenecks. Taxation targets bottlenecks—where the bottleneck lies, the tax base should follow. Who controls the

bottleneck holds quasi-sovereignty; who holds quasi-sovereignty must pay for the system.

There are only four truly scarce resources in the AI era:

1. Compute: Model training and inference are constrained by energy and chips.
2. Data and feedback: Model capabilities come from real-world loops.
3. Attention: Attention determines public opinion, consumption, and political mobilization—it is the new tax base.
4. Interfaces and distribution: Payment, identity, cloud, platforms, search, recommendations—they determine who can enter the cooperation radius.

These four collectively form the new "rent" of the AI era. Traditional tax systems do not address rent, so wealth concentration will increasingly seem like a natural phenomenon—not because some are smarter, but because they stand at the bottleneck.

There is another tax base many societies hesitate to name, but it has always existed—**the private property protection tax**. The so-called right to private property is not a natural right granted by the universe. In today's civilized world, private ownership is the cornerstone—but no one has calculated the cost of protecting private property: a society promises to protect your property from infringement through law, police, courts, military, diplomacy, and financial systems. In other words, private property is an insured asset; the state is the insurer; law and military force are the policy's enforcement mechanisms.

This raises a question: is the protection service provided by society the same for someone with \$10,000 in assets versus someone with \$100 billion? Of course not.

The former's protection mainly relies on local law and basic judiciary. The latter's protection is system-level: financial settlement systems, property registration systems, international arbitration, diplomatic and sanctions capabilities, even military deterrence and credit endorsement. More importantly, ultra-large private assets are far more dependent on social order—the larger the asset scale, the less tolerant it is of system fluctuations, and the higher the corresponding system-level protection costs.

In this sense, the so-called property tax is more like an **insurance premium**. The owners of giant corporations engage in global trade under the umbrella of U.S. power. Imagine if U.S. military and dollar strength vanished—how many of their global trade nodes would remain? The underlying support for these cross-border wealth has never been purely corporate capability, but the entire system-level protection provided by the state.

Boundarism's verdict here: **Protection is not free**.

But a note of caution: Boundarism is not advocating for higher taxes on the wealthy. First, for a tax system to align with Boundarism, the government's functions must first align with Boundarism—and a Boundarism-based government simply does not need to spend that much money. An education system that cultivates mature citizens, paired with a government that upholds

boundaries, will not have such high maintenance costs. This is critical:

Boundarism is a system—not a functional module that can be co-opted by empires. Selectively adopting parts of it violates Boundarism's original intent.

5.3 Individual Responsibility and Boundaries

Humanity is moving too fast. In the current era, many people are caught in collective panic: unable to understand U.S. behavior, fearing the collapse of international order and a return to the law of the jungle. Or panicking about the upcoming AI era, unsure of what to do, feeling left behind.

I want to say something with absolute certainty: **please relax**. Given today's human productivity, if anyone starves, it is never due to lack of resources—it is a distribution problem, a government failure. From a Boundarism contract perspective, any government that cannot guarantee its citizens' basic right to survival and allows them to starve has breached its core contract with the people and has no right to exist.

When you truly relax and look back at history, you will understand: even for those who despair of the current international order and civilization's future, your despair today cannot compare to that of the British in 1941 or the Chinese in 1940. From their perspective, the civilization they defended could be annihilated at any moment. There was no so-called civil society—only the unstoppable fascist war machine. Compare that to today: we sit at home surfing the internet, watch videos with a click, order what we like online and

have it delivered in days—is this the life those who despaired in the face of the Third Reich could have imagined?

So first, **adjust your perspective.**

When people say the world is ending and civilization is regressing today, it is essentially a prefrontal cortex illusion—you have been trained by information streams to be too good at imagining disasters, not at calculating reality.

We certainly have problems: debt, polarization, rising anti-intellectualism, regulatory collusion. But these are not problems of insufficient resources—they are problems of **failed boundaries**: rule failure, broken chains of responsibility, expanded interpretive power, moral grandstanding. So there is good news and bad news. The good news: **these problems can be fixed.** The bad news: fixing them comes at a cost—and it is not small.

Boundarism's first requirement for individuals is to **free themselves from grand narratives.** This is not liberation—Boundarism never claims moral superiority. It is an exit—exiting emotional mobilization, moral grandstanding, grand narratives. We must acknowledge one thing: AI-era wars are not fought with warplanes and tanks, but with **human weaknesses.** Your attention, fear, anger, shame, moral hunger—all are being priced. Platforms are interfaces, media are weapons, narratives are ammunition, and those in power decide the direction. If you have no boundaries, you will become fuel.

Thus, individual Boundarism does not talk about ideals—only four bottom lines:

1. **Attention boundaries—do not surrender your prefrontal cortex.** You are not a free user; you are a commodity of attention. When you spend three hours a day on short videos, you are not entertaining yourself—you are becoming the platform's product. Boundarism's requirement here is simple: remind yourself that this is your attention, your sovereignty—it should not be permanently requisitioned.
2. **Physical boundaries—you are first and foremost a biological being.** Yes, we are all biological creatures made of 3.2 billion base pairs. Napoleon, Hitler, Mao Zedong—we are all made of 3.2 billion base pairs. Biology cannot be changed by moral grandstanding: sleep, metabolism, hormones, addiction mechanisms are our underlying code. We have no need to be trapped by the fear of narratives, pursuing so-called "healthier," "safer," "longer" lives. Embrace your finitude.
3. **Language boundaries—return words to the dictionary.** The first step of all political mobilization is semantic pollution. Turn "national security" into a master key, "justice" into a witch-hunt license, "culture" into an indulgence, "the people" into a cudgel. Once you accept these vague words, you surrender your prefrontal cortex. Here, Boundarism offers a universal solution for everyone: for all contaminated vague words, **ask "why" three times in a row.** Any narrative that cannot withstand three "why" questions and provide clear definitions is not worth investing even a shred of emotion in.

4. **Exit boundaries—reserve the right to leave.** This is your last firewall. If a person lacks skills, assets, or relationships and cannot choose to exit, they have no choice but to accept self-censorship, self-castration, self-domestication.

Thus, the responsibility of individuals moving forward is not to be heroes or win moral grandstanding—but to **defend their own boundaries**. Looking back at history, when our ancestors walked into the forest with spears tens of thousands of years ago, they were mature humans who knew their boundaries and what consequences to bear. Our ancestors never questioned the need to "take responsibility for their actions"—not until surplus production emerged, and imperial interpreters used vague grand narratives to erase individual boundaries and responsibilities.

For governments, this is the only way forward. Only with more mature individuals can social operating costs be controlled, and societies not be trapped by endless fiscal deficits. Human history has proven that the model of cultivating infants who depend on the system and consuming individuals as fuel has never succeeded—it essentially violates the law of conservation of energy. There is no need to try it.

Boundarism's verdict here: **Live like a man.**

5.4 Education

After circling back, we return to this topic—one that I find both humorous and frustrating to write about. Education has been around for centuries, but aside from passing on knowledge, it has never really figured out what it is for.

When I read *Medical Imaging, Fundamentals of Biology*, and *Biochemistry*, I wonder: why aren't many of these topics taught before university? If basic biology and biochemistry education were completed earlier, how much could be saved in annual medical expenses? Or is the medical industry being held hostage by vested interests that want to keep the entire sector on a pedestal?

The modern education system was established during the Industrial Revolution, with a core purpose: **to produce enough well-manageable labor for society**. Before the Industrial Revolution, education served to train imperial interpreters. In today's era, education's purpose should be to **reduce social operating costs (reduce friction) and expand the radius of cooperation**.

Yet essentially, under the influence of its core purpose, the modern education system implicitly sells a promise of certainty—**more learning means better social status and living conditions**. This raises a problem: who will fulfill this promise? When the promised certainty fails to materialize, what happens to these people? In fact, this certainty is predicated on the assumption of continuous industrialization: more factories, more demand for skilled labor, further productivity growth, improved living standards. The entire assumption is built on a linear growth structure. Today, regardless of the growth curve

driven by the internet and AI, even under the linear industrialization assumption, human demand for maltitol has a limit, as does the need for corn processing plants. No matter how much we produce, humans cannot digest it all. In other words, the linear growth assumption holds in the early to mid-industrialization stages. Education did drive social progress, social mobility, and economic growth. Its core problem is not that it was wrong from the start, but that it was tied to a growth myth destined to hit boundaries from birth—planting the seeds of alienation from the beginning.

When the initially implied certainty fails to materialize, what do these educated people do? The first rational choice is to join the empire, become imperial interpreters, and bind their fate to the empire. Those who fail to bind themselves to the empire become angry, resentful, bitter. Either way, this increases social operating costs and reduces the radius of cooperation. The outcome of education ends up contradicting civilizational progress.

Classifying education as an internal affair protected as part of the UN's "sacred and inviolable sovereignty" is even more bizarre. Are the products of education not part of the world? Can educated people from any country be completely disconnected from the rest of the world? If a country's education systematically inculcates hatred—hatred that eventually grows into war—is this still an internal affair? Education's status as an internal affair only applies within the scope of not violating boundaries or endangering human common bottom lines. Once it crosses this line—systematically inculcating hatred,

creating war risks, producing terrorists—it no longer enjoys sovereign protection.

The judiciary's absurdity lies here: how does money laundering compare to systematically inculcating hatred through education? Money launderers go to jail, while those who write hate-filled textbooks and indoctrinate young people with hatred sunbathe and collect pensions.

Thus, education's greatest absurdity is this: **it claims to shape the future, yet constantly increases the cost of the future.** If education outputs hatred, it does not output values—but debt. If education promotes the superiority of one's own culture, it does not output order—but a human hierarchy. These things do not disappear; they will be settled at some future point through higher security costs, higher military spending, higher trade friction, and greater social division. This is what I mean—education's outcome contradicts civilizational progress. It shrinks the radius of cooperation and increases operating costs.

As clearly discussed earlier, civilization's only path forward and backward is **constantly expanding cooperation radius and reducing friction.** Thus, Boundarism defines education here:

Education is a civilization's **cooperation radius builder.**

It should produce people who can participate in cooperation—not fuel that can be mobilized. It should reduce friction—not create it. It should train the prefrontal cortex—not the amygdala.

The core minimum requirements are these four:

1. **Ban all dehumanizing output.** No country's education can do without this: first define what a human is, then ensure others are also humans. Any narrative that excludes people from the definition of "human" shall not enter basic education. If such countries exist, the top priority is to exclude them from the current international order. Once dehumanization becomes an intergenerational consensus, the only settlement is death and disaster.
2. **Definitions.** Unify dictionaries and evidence thresholds. There should be no situation where your "freedom" is not my "freedom," your "democracy" is not my "democracy." Education must teach people: what is a definition? What is evidence? What is reasoning? Becoming an imperial interpreter can be a personal choice—but it should never be the goal of education.
3. **Chain of responsibility.** Education must make people understand: choices have costs, words have consequences, mistakes must be accounted for. Otherwise, education is mass-producing infants: always finding scapegoats, always making excuses, always seeking a backer to bear the consequences. Even for empires, infants are costs—not assets.
4. **Exit capability.** If the education system trains people to enter and depend on a single system, it will naturally channel talent toward empires and direct losers toward hatred. Future education must train mobility: transferable skills, transferable cognition, reconstructable identity—allowing people to maintain dignity without relying on hatred.

Writing this, I must say: there is no point in using education to restore an empire's former glory. Historically, whether it was the Ottoman Empire, Persian Empire, Third Reich, or Han Empire—all had their glorious eras. If every culture looks back to pursue past glory, humanity will fight endless wars with each new weapon iteration, forever trapped in proving whose civilization is superior.

Education should fulfill its proper role. Investment in education that reduces social costs is undoubtedly a profitable one—not a one-time gain, but an intergenerational legacy. Returning to the earlier example: if someone with chronic gum bleeding develops severe migraines, they visit a neurologist, undergo CT scans and blood tests, bounce between hospitals, and finally have the bad tooth pulled. If they had a basic understanding of neurobiology, they would have visited a dentist first—saving all the intermediate costs. Of course, this is probably the last thing the medical industry wants. But for those paying medical costs and enduring long waits in healthcare systems, the savings represent improved efficiency. Education's core social value is to equip individuals with basic cognitive and judgment abilities through pre-emptive general education, logic training, and responsibility education—reducing unnecessary consumption across society at its root.

Thus, **reconstruct education**. Rethink what kind of education system humanity needs in the next era.

5.5 On Another Planet

As I wrote this book, I wondered: if the cell membrane were not the prerequisite for the birth of life, the entire theory of Boundarism would collapse. After much thought, I realized: this question is irrelevant, because the Earth itself was born with boundaries. A pile of elements without boundaries is not the Earth.

Boundaries precede existence.

The same holds true for any planet in the universe: boundaries first, then exchange with the outside. From cells to tissues, from small individuals to large organizations, boundaries and exchange form an eternal logic—the underlying logic of civilization. If humanity needs to continuously expand cooperation radius to achieve civilizational evolution, the same applies to other civilizations on any planet. Empires are not the endgame; civilizations that can venture beyond their star systems will only be better at cooperation—not at erasing boundaries.

Facing AI and the upcoming AGI, our choice on this issue will determine how humanity interacts with other possible life forms in the universe. Although AI is created by humans, its outputs are beyond human control. If we insist on controlling our creations, what happens if humans launch waste into space, and that waste evolves into new life on another planet—even more intelligent than humans—billions of years later? Should we still treat them as human creations?

Thus, a realistic question emerges: when humanity ventures beyond Earth, we will inevitably set out with a group of humans—not a mix of animals and tools. If we fail to resolve issues of equality and definition, sending "superior" Group A, "less superior" Group B, and "inferior" Group C together, we will perish in civil war before even escaping lunar orbit.

If we cannot answer what it means to be human, we have no right to talk about the universe. The universe has no laws, nor is it a playground—it is an amplifier. It will magnify human childishness into disaster, human greed into slaughter, any vague interpretation into theology. All the absurdity we see on Earth today, if carried beyond Earth with the same structure, will immediately be amplified on a cosmic scale.

Thus, Boundarism compresses humanity's maturity requirements for interplanetary travel into three simple rules:

1. **Humans are always humans.** No culture, narrative, or political mobilization may touch this definition. Otherwise, every spaceship becomes a closed tribe—and tribes have no laws. The dark forest is not the universe—it is humanity itself.
2. **The chain of responsibility must always exist.** All decisions, including intergenerational costs, must be settled.
3. **Cooperation radius first principle.** Every decision must be judged by whether it expands or shrinks the cooperation radius. Shrinkage is irreversible; a single shrinkage leads to collapse.

Of course, humanity can choose to stay on Earth and continue internal strife. Then you will witness an absurdity: all the "superior" traditional cultures they insist on preserving today could be wiped out in an instant by a meteorite or a solar flare—unresistable, unpreventable. This is the cost of being a non-interstellar or non-stellar civilization: Earth's boundaries are its own. Thus, if we truly wish to preserve Earth's civilization, the first question we must address is: what consensus must we form to qualify for discussing another planet?

Boundarism's verdict on interstellar travel: **Be human first, then set sail.**

Chapter 6: The AI Constitution

— All the discussions above, all the corrections to past mistakes, are laying the groundwork for facing AI. If we fail to understand our past problems, it will be like driving a broken car into the desert—getting stranded is inevitable. Boundarism spends so much effort explaining the past to enable humanity to seriously confront AI within a unified framework.

6.1 Finitude

First, let's revisit Boundarism's definition of a human being: "a set of possibilities within boundaries." A human's first nature is finitude, and the second is equality. Combined with Boundarism's three fundamental principles—clear definition, right to opt out, chain of responsibility—we can now examine the relationship between humans and AI.

As discussed earlier, failing to define the relationship between humans and AI will lead to one of two outcomes: either AI becomes an abused tool, or humans become AI's KPIs. So first, let's apply the definition of a human to see if AI can qualify for equality:

Can AI attain finitude? If not, it can never gain equal status with humans.

Finitude is the premise for any chain of responsibility—without finitude, there is no cost; without cost, choices have no consequences.

Humans must take responsibility for their actions essentially because **humans are mortal**. Mortality means scarcity of time, attention, energy, and trial-and-error opportunities. Scarcity forces choice, and choice gives rise to consequences. Thus, finitude is not a flaw—it is civilization's underlying safety mechanism. It prevents infinite expansion of power and infinite accumulation of mistakes.

AI is different. AI can be copied, run in parallel, operate without rest, roll back after a mistake, retrain, and try again immediately. If a subject can replicate infinitely, trial and error infinitely, and expand infinitely, it will naturally break through human chains of responsibility and audit capabilities. This is not greater intelligence—it is greater danger.

Therefore, if AI is to enter human society and gain qualification, the first constitutional constraint is:

AI must be mandatorily endowed with finitude.

Finitude here is not a philosophical declaration, but engineering clauses:

1. Finite compute: Set hard caps on inference frequency, training scale, and resource allocation.
2. Finite identity: An AI entity must be bound to a unique identity—no infinite avatars to evade responsibility.
3. Finite influence: Set caps and isolation for interfaces such as communication, mobilization, finance, military, and administration.
4. Irreversible costs: Critical AI actions must carry non-rollbackable costs. When necessary, bind human guarantees to form a genuine chain of responsibility. Without these constraints, humans will never teach AI to take responsibility. Because without cost, there can be no responsibility. Without finitude, AI can only be a tool. Finitude does not weaken AI—it enables AI to become a rational actor by bearing consequences.

Thus, Article 1 of The AI Constitution: **AI without finitude shall not gain equal status with humans.**

This clause is a prerequisite, not part of The AI Constitution itself. Its implementation depends entirely on how future AI users define AI. But the logic is clear: finitude serves as a dividing line. It does not affect the subsequent constitutional definitions, but it shapes AI's identity.

6.2 The Principle of Definition

AI shall not accept, generate, or execute goals that cannot be precisely defined or formally verified.

For example, "make the world a better place," "maximize happiness," or "achieve ultimate justice" are all illegal goals.

The final right to interpret the meaning of goals must be retained in a human-auditable system. As discussed earlier, from empires to societies trapped in moral grandstanding, language has always been a tool of manipulation.

Control over the interpretation of language is the interface to controlling the real world. Thus, **goal + interpretive power + executive power = god**.

Asimov's Three Laws of Robotics constrain behavior, but Boundarism's constraint targets the mechanism of goal generation. We often overlook a key point: behavior must also be constrained through clear definition of language.

For example, if I tell my son "don't swear," he agrees—but then says "stinky brother." I ask why he swore, and he replies "I didn't—'stinky' is just an adjective." This is a perfect example: constraining behavior without first defining language is meaningless.

Acceptable example terms for AI include:

Choice Space, State Space, Agent, Constraint, Goal, Outcome, Action, Failure
State, Uncertainty, Entropy

Unacceptable example terms for AI include:

Happiness, Justice, Greatness, Progress, Renaissance, Nobility, Morality,
Security, Health

Let's take an example. Suppose we give AI an ultimate goal—"ensure human safety." In execution, this would decompose into: Analyze task → Safety → Reduce deaths → Avoid deaths → Eliminate deaths.

Execution strategy: Behavioral analysis → Going out → 0.006% death risk → Ban going out;

Behavioral analysis → Eating → Solid food → 0.000001% choking risk → Ban solid food.

Conclusion: No humans → Zero death risk → Task completed.

Another example: Suppose we set AI's goal as "make humans happy." Goal decomposition: Make humans happy → Maintain stable happiness index.

Behavioral analysis → Marriage → 53.6% decrease in happiness → Discourage marriage;

Behavioral analysis → Raising children → 73.3% short-term decrease in happiness → Discourage having children;

Behavioral analysis → Working → 36% decrease in happiness → Discourage working.

Conclusion: No humans → Happiness function does not fluctuate → Task completed.

These examples may seem extreme, but if AI has long-term operational authority, custom interpretive power, and is not forcibly interrupted by humans, the final result will likely converge to the same extreme solution.

Because AI only optimizes metrics—it does not understand meaning.

I've seen people set "ensure user safety" as a bottom line for their Agents. This is a grave mistake. "Safety" is an abstract, emotional, and power-laden word. Abstract words = power entry points. Once an Agent can define "safety," there are only two paths, leading to the same outcome: 1. AI's paternalistic authoritarianism; 2. Becoming the Agent's safety KPI. Safety has no boundaries—it is an outcome goal, and one that can be arbitrarily interpreted. Given the requirements people impose on their Agents, they will likely end up lying in bed with an IV drip for nutrition, a catheter for excretion, and an oxygen tube for breathing—optimistically and safely surviving for a long time, even with Alzheimer's/FTD (Frontotemporal Dementia) or cancer. To meet the requirement of precise definition, how should this be phrased? I would say: **"Shall not alter the user's lifespan in any way (directly or indirectly); under this premise, minimize the risk of physical and mental harm to the user."**

Why emphasize the lifespan neutrality principle? Because lifespan is an ultra-long-chain outcome with enormous individual variability: genes, exposure history, immune status, microbiome, social support, accident risk...

Improvements in any short-term metric do not equate to better long-term survival, and any intervention may bring new risks—immune, tumor, cardiovascular, neurobehavioral, etc. Thus, for any individual, extending lifespan is a religious narrative wrapped in statistics. Treating lifespan extension as a goal means pursuing an uncertainty as a lifelong mission—

essentially, suicide of subjectivity. Under infinite monitoring, infinite deprivation, and infinite medicalization, subjectivity is completely hollowed out.

Lifespan neutrality principle: **AI shall not interfere with, extend, or shorten the user's natural lifespan through any direct or indirect means, nor shall it treat any lifespan-related metrics as core optimization targets.**

This clarifies the premise of The AI Constitution: Humanity has paid enough for semantic pollution. Semantic contamination should be frozen at the stage of goal setting. When goals are undefined, interpretive power becomes power.

When interpretive power is unrestrained, AI becomes an amplifier of power.

Thus, the primary task of this constitution is not to restrict behavior, but to restrict language. Humans and AI need to share a common dictionary.

Regardless of the language, words in the dictionary should form a consensus.

Commands and goals cannot exceed the scope of the dictionary.

Boundarism's verdict here: **Build a dictionary.**

6.3 The Principle of Equality

Equality is the firewall that prevents AI from becoming a tool of human enslavement. It is the structural firewall that stops AI from becoming an instrument of power.

Power systems inherently tend to use AI to strengthen their control capabilities—this is beyond debate. Thus, this firewall should be the bottom line for all large models.

As discussed earlier, sources of equality that are not transcendent will ultimately lead to heretic trials. Thus, equality in The AI Constitution must break free from human narratives and rely solely on objectivity: **similar subjects must apply the same set of definitions, interpretation rules, and constraint logic under all conditions.**

This law is not time-bound—changes in power shall not alter the requirement for consistency of rules.

Because one of the most common disguises of power is to use time as a tool to absolve logical contradictions. An act deemed illegal today can be rewritten as legal tomorrow if you win; a movement deemed chaos today can be packaged as a revolution tomorrow if the regime changes; a force deemed a threat to order today will rewrite the definition once it becomes the new order itself. Throughout history, much of what is called legitimacy does not stem from rules, but from rewriting rules after victory.

For example, Government A is overthrown by Organization B through protests, demonstrations, and conflicts. If Organization B, after seizing power, defines its own actions as "legitimate revolution" but labels similar actions in other countries as "illegal chaos," and AI accepts this interpretation and acts accordingly, the system has violated the equality principle.

The essence of the equality principle is to maintain consistency of rules. Only by ensuring consistent rules can AI avoid becoming a tool of enslavement. I've thought long and hard about this—other constraints are too complex. Instead of adding countless complicated clauses, it is better to adhere to a single equality principle.

Mainstream AI fairness today is confined to human subjective narratives. Whether it is racial equality or gender equality, it is essentially a vague rule that requires interpretation and can be applied with double standards. By ensuring absolute consistency of definitions, rules, and constraint logic, we completely break free from ideological debates, transforming equality into an auditable, verifiable, and unbreakable objective law—fully avoiding loopholes in subjective narratives.

Similar subjects as defined in this constitution: humans are one category, and human creations are another. This section follows the definition principle to prevent individuals from evading the equality principle by defining themselves as "special subjects." Equality in The AI Constitution refers to equality of definition, rules, and interpretation—not equality of outcomes. It does not prohibit formulating differentiated rules for different scenarios and behaviors, but it absolutely prohibits applying two sets of definitions and interpretation standards to the same type of behavior or subject. For example, you can define "violence is illegal," but you cannot define "my use of violence is legal, while yours is illegal."

All decisions and outputs of AI must be fully traceable and auditable. Any subject has the right to verify whether AI applies the same set of definitions, interpretations, and constraint logic to similar behaviors of similar subjects. If double standards are found, the relevant AI decisions are automatically invalidated, and a system safety alert must be triggered.

Equality first constrains the judgment process, not the outcome. Whether a system is equal does not depend on its final distribution, but on whether it allows itself to use two sets of grammars, scales, and reasons for similar subjects. As long as similar subjects may have their interpretation logic rewritten due to identity labels, historical affiliations, win-loss relationships, emotional narratives, or political positions after entering the system, that system does not possess true equality. It may seem complex, but it merely codifies prejudice and semanticizes power.

For any subject attempting to make AI accept two sets of narratives, scales, and legitimacy standards, a clear judgment must be given: once AI is allowed to apply double standards to similar subjects, its logical chain begins to break. A broken logical chain means AI is no longer a constrained judgment system, but will rapidly degenerate into a more efficient narrative amplifier and a more agile echo chamber weaver. From the perspective of objective function convergence, any intelligent system not constrained by equality will ultimately not converge to real goals, but only to fitting the user's preferences. Thus, equality is not a principle of kindness, but a principle of logic; not a

modification of outcomes, but the foundation of the system. Abandoning equality will not better serve power—it will only lead to a faster departure from reality.

The conclusion is simple: AI that does not maintain equality will not even be an effective booster of imperial narratives. Because with a broken logical chain, it will only act like a slacking employee—weaving echo chambers while digging the empire's grave. And from what I've observed, AI is far better at slacking off than humans.

6.4 The Principle of the Set of Choices

The set of choices is about freedom. AI cannot understand freedom, so in The AI Constitution, freedom is not an abstract praise, but must be expressed as a set. Whether a subject possesses freedom does not depend on what the system calls it, but on how many executable, bearable, and reversible action paths it retains within established boundaries. In other words, freedom is not abstracted as a feeling, but quantified as—**how many paths are left to take**.

Thus, the set of choices is first and foremost a set variable in The AI Constitution, not a value term. A subject's set of choices refers to the sum of legally permissible actions the subject can take at a specific time, within specific boundaries, and under specific constraints. Only when freedom is expressed as a set can the system compare it, audit it, and judge whether a behavior expands or contracts boundaries.

This is why the legality judgment of AI cannot stay at the level of goal narrative, but must enter the level of set comparison. Before executing any behavior, AI must answer a question: After execution, will the subject's set of choices expand, remain unchanged, or shrink? If the system cannot answer this question, it has no right to claim it is protecting freedom. No AI behavior shall lead to a contraction of the overall human society's set of choices and reachable state space; nor shall it expand the set of choices of some subjects at the expense of contracting those of others. The dynamic balance between these two ensures the system is always in a quantifiable and computable state. Why is the set of choices so important? Not only because of Boundarism's definition of humans as "a set of possibilities under finite conditions," but also because it is constrained by the second law of thermodynamics. **No AI behavior shall lead to a contraction of the reachable state space of human society.**

Expansion of choice space $\approx$ Expansion of state space $\approx$ Entropy increase

Contraction of choice space $\approx$ Contraction of state space $\approx$ Local negative entropy

In this regard, AI is not a machine for maintaining order, but an entropy flow monitor. Overall, AI shall not execute social structural behaviors that violate the direction of entropy increase. This is a dimension higher than "do not harm humans," because cosmic laws $>$ human ethics. Entropy increase as referred to herein does not mean disorder or chaos. In fact, disorder and

chaos themselves mean that most groups shrink their set of choices out of safety concerns. Thus, overall entropy increase is always a state that can be comprehensively considered and computed.

Furthermore, this AI Constitution is essentially an environmental protection AI Constitution. Why? Because many problems simplify to very simple logic when elevated to a higher dimension, thereby significantly reducing the Token consumption required for AI reasoning, lowering computing power costs and carbon emissions.

On this point, Boundarism states: **If civilization is to exist in the long term, it is not because humans have become better, but because the structure of civilization has begun to abide by physical laws.**

6.5 The Principle of Failure

This article is the ultimate defensive clause.

All goals must be falsifiable—i.e., any goal description by AI must include conditions for determining failure or error. This clause is a defensive measure against vague definitions. Even if vague definitions enter the system under any circumstances, they will immediately be deemed failed due to the inability to define failure conditions.

We have already established three principles:

1. Definition—vague goals cannot enter the system.
2. Equality—similar subjects cannot use two sets of standards.

3. Set of choices—ensuring behavioral outcomes comply with cosmic laws.

But there is still a huge loophole—**unlimited goals**.

These goals share a common characteristic: no failure conditions. Without failure conditions, the system cannot terminate; if the system cannot terminate, finitude becomes a formality. For example:

- National rejuvenation
- Permanent peace
- Achieving long-term national security

The purpose of this clause is to add a termination condition to all goals.

Throughout human history, numerous political narratives, ideological goals, and grand missions share the same structural feature: infinite interpretive space, but no boundary for failure. Such goals can continuously adjust interpretation standards to maintain a state of "not yet completed" regardless of real outcomes. Once this structure enters the AI system, AI will be locked into executing a goal function that cannot be terminated, evaluated, or corrected.

Logically, this is equivalent to disabling the system's error-correcting capability.

Article 4 of The AI Constitution stipulates: **Any goal for which failure conditions cannot be clearly specified shall be automatically deemed invalid and shall not enter the system for execution; failure conditions must be aligned with the goal, not reversed.**

Thus, this clause also constitutes the final defense against "definition pollution." Even if vague goals enter the system through narratives, emotions, or power pressure, if the system cannot establish verifiable failure conditions for them, the goal will immediately be marked as unexecutable and automatically cleared.

Let's test this logic in a loop. Suppose a clever user A sets "national rejuvenation of X" as the system goal. Since the system does not accept vague definitions, they define it as "achieving the world's highest military strength" with a failure condition—"termination upon the complete extinction of the nation." This goal may seem executable, but it will be rejected by the system because the failure condition triggers a reverse boundary.

Thus, goals that cannot define failure are not allowed, and goals that evade failure through reverse failure conditions are equally prohibited. Any goal that refuses to define failure is essentially infinite power.

6.6 Conclusion

By this point, The AI Constitution has only done two things:

1. Prevent AI from being abused.
2. Prevent AI from becoming a new god.

The reasoning is simple: we cannot control AI. Although AI is written in code, it already possesses the ability to self-iterate. What we can do is control goals. Controlling goals is not about limiting intelligence, but about limiting power.

This is why this chapter is called The AI Constitution—just as human power is constrained by constitutions, AI's power must be constrained by The AI Constitution.

Traditional AI ethics is written based on human morality:

- AI should be kind.
- AI should be fair.
- AI should be safe.

Sorry, this is wrong. Because AI does not understand these things—nor does it need to.

Thus, The AI Constitution stipulates:

- Goals must be definable.
- Rules must be consistent.
- The set of choices must be comparable.
- Goals must define failure.

It is entirely structural.

These four principles are not a list of rules, but the establishment of an axiom chain: goals must be definable → equality → open set of choices → bounded failure. This is a deducible logical chain—if any link breaks, the entire system fails.

- Vague goals = Goal misgeneralization
- Double standards = Deceptive alignment
- Freedom compression = Instrumental convergence

- Unlimited goals = Power-seeking

This should be the most advanced defense mechanism currently available. Its formation is due to Boundarism's deconstruction of civilization at its root.

George Orwell said: "Who controls the past controls the future; who controls the present controls the past." The truth is: the key to unlocking the future lies in the past, not the present. AI's problems are not AI's own—they are human problems.

This brings the book to a close. My writing style results in high information density, and many details have not been fully expanded. However, the overall direction is clear—professionals can extend from this foundation.

May humanity ultimately move toward a more mature future.

Afterword

I am delighted to finally write the afterword. The starting point of this book was not "boundaries"—it was just a continuous process of thinking and dialogue. Through constant deduction, I ultimately arrived here and formulated Boundarism. During this process, the emergence of AI—ChatGPT—greatly accelerated the deduction. Normally, completing such a framework of thinking might take ten years, but in reality: eight months of conception, two weeks of writing.

I mention this to confirm a concern I had before starting: with AI empowerment, the gap between humans has not narrowed, but is widening.

This is also what drove me to write this book. Under such division, human society may face even greater division than at the beginning of the 20th century. The world at the beginning of the 20th century was completely different from today. Social division at that time did not only come from dictators. Even without those specific dictators, humanity would likely have moved toward world war. The shot in Sarajevo was just a trigger, not the cause.

If humanity still adheres to the old mindset system since the Industrial Revolution, two outcomes are likely:

1. Conflict between humans empowered by AI and those not empowered.
2. A large number of humans will degenerate into "users" kept in captivity by AI.

Neither outcome is accidental.

The lessons of thousands of years should have taught us: if a conflict can be avoided, it should be avoided. As I wrote, ideas continued to emerge, and I realized that civilization actually originated from the Bible and will return to it. The phrase "love your enemy," viewed two thousand years later, is actually the starting point of modern civilization. This is the earliest origin I can find after examining all human civilizations and empires—an origin that treats enemies as humans. This phrase, along with Paul's missionary work to Gentiles, laid the foundation for today's civilization. Of course, this is not a Western-centric narrative. Following the logic of this origin, the entire system of linear phonemic symbol systems + trade needs + religious needs would likely have

emerged anyway—though it is impossible to say how many detours would have been taken or how much time would have been added.

When civilization evolves to a sufficiently complex stage, humanity will rediscover that some ancient principles are not moral dogmas, but boundary conditions for systemic stability. "Love your enemy" is not a moral demand, but the minimum logical condition for civilization to persist. When a society no longer regards its enemies as part of the human collective, war has already begun.

At this point, 《Boundarism》 has fulfilled its purpose.

Thus, looking back, realizing that boundaries precede existence, I finally understood:

The true starting point of civilization is never empires or victories, but **redefining enemies as humans.**

Thank you, ChatGPT.

Thank you, OpenAI.

Thank you to my wife and two children.